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# 2 Peter

## 2 Peter - Introduction

### Part 1: General Introduction

**Outline of 2 Peter**

1. Introduction (1:1–2)
2. Reminder to live godly lives because God has enabled us to do so (1:3–15)
3. Reminder of the veracity of apostolic teaching (1:16–21)
4. Prediction of false teachers (2:1–3)
5. Examples of divine judgment (2:4–10a)
6. Description and denunciation of false teachers (2:10b–22)
7. Reminder that Jesus will return at the right time (3:1–13)
8. Concluding exhortation to live godly lives (3:14–17)

**Who wrote the book of 2 Peter?**
The author identified himself as Simon Peter. Simon Peter was an apostle. He also wrote the book of 1 Peter. Peter probably wrote this letter while in a prison in Rome, just before he died. Peter called this letter his second letter, so we can date it after 1 Peter. He addressed the letter to the same audience as his first letter. The audience probably was Christians scattered throughout Asia Minor.

**What is the book of 2 Peter about?**
Peter wrote this letter to encourage believers to live good lives. He warned them about false teachers who were saying Jesus was taking too long to return. He told them that Jesus was not slow in returning. Instead, God was giving people time to repent so that they would be saved.

**How should the title of this book be translated?**
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "2 Peter" or "Second Peter." Or they may choose a clearer title, such as "The Second Letter from Peter" or "The Second Letter Peter Wrote." (See: How to Translate Names)

### Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

**Who were the people Peter spoke against?**
It is possible that the people Peter spoke against were those who would become known as Gnostics. These teachers distorted the teachings of Scripture for their own gain. They lived in immoral ways and taught others to do the same.

**What does it mean that God inspired Scripture?**
The doctrine of Scripture is a very important one. 2 Peter helps readers to understand that while each writer of Scripture had his own distinct way of writing, God is the true author of Scripture (1:20–21).

### Part 3: Important Translation Issues

**Singular and plural "you"**
In this book, the word "I" refers to Peter. Also, the word "you" is always plural and refers to Peter's audience. (See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'; and Forms of You)

**What are the major issues in the text of the book of 2 Peter?**
For the following verses, there are differences between some of the ancient manuscripts. The ULT text follows the reading that most scholars consider to be original and puts the other reading in a footnote. If a translation of the Bible exists in the language of wider communication in the region, translators may want to consider using the reading found in that version. If not, translators are advised to follow the reading in the ULT.

- "to be kept in chains of lower darkness until the judgment" (2:4). Some ancient manuscripts have, "to be kept in pits of lower darkness until the judgment."
- "They enjoy their deceitful actions while they are feasting with you" (2:13). Some manuscripts have, "They enjoy their actions while they are feasting with you in love feasts."
- "Bosor" (2:15). A few other manuscripts read, "Beor."
- "The elements will be burned with fire, and the earth and the deeds in it will be revealed" (3:10). Other manuscripts have, "The elements will be burned with fire, and the earth and the deeds in it will be burned up."

(See: Textual Variants)

## 2 Peter - Chapter 1 Introduction

### Structure and Formatting

1. Introduction (1:1–2)
2. Reminder to live good lives, because God has enabled us to do so (1:3–15)
3. Reminder of the veracity of apostolic teaching (1:16–21)

Peter begins this letter in 1:1–2 by giving his name, identifying the people to whom he is writing, and offering a greeting. That was the way people typically began letters at this time.

### Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

**Knowledge of God**
Having experiential knowledge of God means to belong to him or to have a relationship with him. Here, "knowledge" is more than just mentally knowing about God. It is the knowledge of personal relationship in which God saves a person and gives him grace and peace. (See: know, knew, knowledge, known, unknown, distinguish)

**Living godly lives**
Peter teaches that God has given believers all that they need for living godly lives. Therefore, believers should do everything they can to obey God more and more. If believers continue to do this, then they will be effective and productive through their relationship with Jesus. However, if believers do not continue living godly lives, then it is as though they have forgotten what God did through Christ to save them. (See: godly, godliness, ungodly, godless, ungodliness, godlessness; and save, saved, safe, salvation, rescue)

### Translation Issues in This Chapter

**The truth of Scripture**
Peter teaches that the prophecies in Scripture were not made up by men. The Holy Spirit revealed God's message to the men who spoke them or wrote them down. Also, Peter and the other apostles did not make up the stories they told people about Jesus. They witnessed what Jesus did and heard God call Jesus his son.

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#8)

**ἐν δικαιοσύνῃ**

**"by the righteousness"**

The word **by** indicates the means through which they received the faith. Alternate translation: [by means of the righteousness]

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#6)

**τοῖς ἰσότιμον & λαχοῦσιν πίστιν**

**"to the ones having received a faith equal in value"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **faith** with a verb, such as "trust" or "believe." Alternate translation: [to those whom God has made to trust] or [to those whom God has made to believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#7)

**ἡμῖν**

**"with us"**

Here, the word **us** refers to Peter and the other apostles, but not to those to whom he is writing. Alternate translation: [as we apostles have received]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#1)

**Σίμων Πέτρος**

**"Simon Peter"**

In this culture, letter writers would give their own names first, and they would refer to themselves in the third person. If that would be confusing in your language, you could use the first person. If your language has a particular way of introducing the author of a letter, you could also use that. Alternate translation: [I, Simon Peter, am writing this letter] or [From Simon Peter]

See: First, Second or Third Person

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#5)

**τοῖς ἰσότιμον ἡμῖν λαχοῦσιν πίστιν**

**"to the ones having received a faith equal in value with us"**

That these people have **received a faith** implies that God has given that faith to them. Alternate translation: [to those to whom God has given a faith equal in value with us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#4)

**τοῖς & λαχοῦσιν**

**"the ones having received"**

In this culture, after giving their own names, letter writers would then say to whom they were writing, naming those people in the third person. If that would be confusing in your language, you could use the second person. Alternate translation: [to you who have received]

See: First, Second or Third Person

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#9)

**δικαιοσύνῃ τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**“the righteousness of our God and Savior”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **righteousness** by translating the idea behind it with an adjective such as “righteous” or “right.” Alternate translation: [the righteous acts of our God and Savior] or [the right way of our God and Savior]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#2)

**Σίμων Πέτρος**

**“Simon Peter”**

**Simon Peter** is the name of a man, a disciple of Jesus. See the information about him in Part 1 of the Introduction to 2 Peter.

See: How to Translate Names

## 2 Peter 1:1 (#3)

**δοῦλος καὶ ἀπόστολος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ**

**“a servant and an apostle of Jesus Christ”**

This phrase gives further information about Simon Peter. He describes himself as being both a **servant of Jesus Christ** and one given the position and authority of being Christ’s **apostle**.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#4)

**χάρις & καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη**

**“May grace and peace be multiplied”**

Peter speaks of **grace and peace** as if they were objects that could increase in size or number. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a different metaphor that means that these things will increase, or use plain language. Alternate translation: [May God increase his grace and peace]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#8)

**τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν**

**“our Lord”**

Here, **our Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.”

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#2)

**χάρις & καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη**

**“May grace and peace be multiplied”**

God is the one who will give **grace** and **peace** to believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make that information explicit. Alternate translation: [May God increase his grace and peace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#5)

**ὑμῖν**

**“to you”**

Here the pronoun **you** is plural, since Peter is writing to believers in Jesus as a group. Generally, throughout the letter the pronouns “you” and “your” are plural for this same reason.

See: Forms of You

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#7)

**ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν**

**“in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord”**

This could mean: (1) “because of knowing God and Jesus our Lord” or (2) “through knowing God and Jesus our Lord.”

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#3)

**χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη**

**“May grace and peace be multiplied to you”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **grace** and **peace** by stating the ideas behind them with equivalent expressions. Alternate translation: [May God multiply his kind acts to you and give you a more peaceful spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#6)

**ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν**

**“in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord”**

If you would not use an abstract noun here, you could translate **knowledge** using a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [because you know God and Jesus our Lord]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:2 (#1)

**χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη**

**“May grace and peace be multiplied to you”**

In this culture, letter writers would offer a good wish for the recipient before introducing the main business of the letter. Use a form in your language that makes it clear that this is a greeting and blessing. Alternate translation: [May God increase his kind acts to you and make you more peaceful]

See: Blessings

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#14)

**διὰ δόξης καὶ ἀρετῆς**

**“through his glory and excellence”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **glory** and **excellence** by stating the ideas behind them with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [because he is so great and so good]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#12)

**ἡμᾶς**

**“us”**

Here, **us** refers to Peter and his audience, fellow believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#5)

**τῆς θείας δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ & δεδωρημένης**

**“his divine power has given”**

Peter is speaking of God’s **divine power** as if it were a living thing that could give something to people. God is the one who is giving, and he uses his **divine power** to do so. Alternate translation: [God has used his divine power to give]

See: Personification

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#11)

**τοῦ καλέσαντος ἡμᾶς**

**“of the one having called us”**

This phrase could refer to: (1) God. Alternate translation: [of God, who called us]; (2) Jesus. Alternate translation: [of Jesus, who called us]

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#2)

**ἡμῖν**

**“to us”**

Here, **us** refers to Peter and all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#1)

**ὡς & ἡμῖν τῆς θείας δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ & δεδωρημένης**

**“As his divine power has given to us”**

Here, **As** indicates that this verse provides the reason for the expected result, which is Peter’s command in 1:5–7. Alternate translation: [Since his divine power has given to us]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#3)

**τῆς θείας δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ**

**“his divine power”**

The pronoun **his** could refer to: (1) God. Alternate translation: [God’s divine power]; (2) Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus, by his power as God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#9)

**διὰ τῆς ἐπιγνώσεως**

**“through the knowledge”**

The word **through** here indicates the means by which God has given us all things for life and godliness. Alternate translation: [by means of the knowledge]

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#13)

**διὰ δόξης καὶ ἀρετῆς**

**“through his glory and excellence”**

Here, **through** indicates the means by which God called us. Alternate translation: [by means of his glory and excellence]

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#10)

**διὰ τῆς ἐπιγνώσεως τοῦ καλέσαντος ἡμᾶς**

**“through the knowledge of the one having called us”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **knowledge** by translating it with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [through our knowing the one who called us]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#7)

**πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν**

**“for life and godliness”**

Here, **godliness** describes the word **life**. Alternate translation: [for a godly life]

See: Hendiadys

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#4)

**τῆς θείας δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ**

**“his divine power”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **power** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [God, because he can do anything,]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#8)

**εὐσέβειαν**

**“godliness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **godliness** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [acting honorably toward God]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:3 (#6)

**πρὸς ζωὴν καὶ εὐσέβειαν**

**“for life and godliness”**

Here, the word **for** indicates the purpose for which God has given all these things to believers. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of life and godliness]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#3)

**ἡμῖν**

**“to us”**

Here, **us** refers to Peter and his audience, fellow believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#12)

**ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ**

**“by lust”**

Here, **by** indicates the means by which the world became corrupt. It does not indicate the means by which Peter’s addressees escaped corruption. Alternate translation: [by means of lust]

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#2)

**δι’ ὧν**

**“through which”**

Here, **which** refers back to words from the previous verse. It could refer to: (1) “his glory and excellence.” Alternate translation: [through his glory and excellence]; (2) “all the things for life and godliness.” Alternate translation: [by giving us all of these things]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#1)

**δι’ ὧν**

**“through which”**

Here, **through** indicates the means by which God gave his promises. Alternate translation: [by means of which]

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#4)

**δεδώρηται**

**“he has given”**

The pronoun **he** could refer to: (1) God. Alternate translation: [God has given]; (2) Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus has given]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#7)

**διὰ τούτων**

**“through them”**

The word **through** here indicates the means by which you might be sharers of the divine nature. Alternate translation: [by means of them]

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#13)

**φθορᾶς**

**“corruption”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **corruption** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [things that corrupt you]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#10)

**ἀποφυγόντες τῆς & φθορᾶς**

**“having escaped the corruption”**

Peter speaks of people not suffering from the **corruption** that wicked desires cause as if they had **escaped** from that corruption. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this phrase plainly. Alternate translation: [no longer being corrupted]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#8)

**διὰ τούτων**

**“through them”**

Here the pronoun **them** refers back to the precious and great promises of the previous phrase. Alternate translation: [through these promises]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#9)

**θείας & φύσεως**

**“of the divine nature”**

The abstract noun **nature** refers to the inherent features of something or what it is like. Alternate translation: [of what God is like]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#6)

**ἵνα διὰ τούτων γένησθε θείας κοινωνοὶ φύσεως**

**“so that through them you might be sharers of the divine nature”**

This is a purpose clause. Peter is stating the purpose for which God has given to us precious and great promises. In your translation, follow the conventions of your language for purpose clauses. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [in order that through them you might be sharers of the divine nature]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#5)

**τὰ τίμια καὶ μέγιστα ἡμῖν ἐπαγγέλματα δεδώρηται**

**“he has given to us the precious and great promises”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **promises** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [he has promised to us precious and great things]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:4 (#11)

**ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ**

**“in the world”**

Here, **the world** could mean: (1) the place where we all live, where we are surrounded by sinful people and temptations to sin. Alternate translation: [that is all around us]; (2) the system of values that people share who do not honor God. Alternate translation: [of the world’s ungodly value system]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#7)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ ἀρετῇ τὴν γνῶσιν**

**“and in goodness, knowledge”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in your goodness, knowledge]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#4)

**ἐπιχορηγήσατε ἐν τῇ πίστει ὑμῶν**

**“supply in your faith”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **faith** with a verb such as “trust” or “believe.” Alternate translation: [as you trust in Jesus, add]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#8)

**τὴν γνῶσιν**

**“knowledge”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **knowledge** using a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [knowing more about God]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#2)

**σπουδὴν πᾶσαν παρεισενέγκαντες**

**“applying all diligence”**

The phrase **applying all diligence** indicates the means by which one is to do the action of supplying that follows. Alternate translation: [by means of applying all diligence]

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#5)

**ὑμῶν**

**“your”**

The pronoun **your** is plural here, since Peter is writing to believers in Jesus as a group. Generally, throughout the letter the pronouns “you” and “your” are plural for this same reason.

See: Forms of You

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#1)

**καὶ αὐτὸ τοῦτο δὲ**

**“and now {for} this same {reason”**

The phrase **{for} this same {reason}** refers to what Peter has just said in the previous verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [and now because of these things that God has done]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#3)

**σπουδὴν πᾶσαν παρεισενέγκαντες**

**“applying all diligence”**

Here, **applying all diligence** is an idiom that means doing one’s best or making the best effort. Alternate translation: [making every effort]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 1:5 (#6)

**τὴν ἀρετήν & τῇ ἀρετῇ**

**“goodness & goodness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **goodness** with an adjective phrase in both occurrences in this verse. Alternate translation: [doing what is good ... doing what is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#4)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ ἐνκρατείᾳ τὴν ὑπομονήν**

**“and in self-control, endurance”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in self-control, endurance]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#3)

**τὴν ἐνκράτειαν & τῇ ἐνκρατείᾳ**

**“self-control & self-control”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **self-control** with a verbal phrase in both occurrences in this verse. Alternate translation: [controlling yourself ... controlling yourself]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#6)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ ὑπομονῇ τὴν εὐσέβειαν**

**“and in endurance, godliness”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in endurance, godliness]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#2)

**τῇ γνώσει**

**“knowledge”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **knowledge** by translating it using a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [knowing more about God]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#5)

**τὴν ὑπομονήν & τῇ ὑπομονῇ**

**“endurance & endurance”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **endurance** with a verbal phrase in both occurrences in this verse.

Alternate translation: [enduring hardship ... enduring hardship]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#7)

**τὴν εὐσέβειαν**

**“godliness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **godliness** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [acting honorably toward God]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:6 (#1)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ γνώσει τὴν ἐνκράτειαν**

**“and in knowledge, self-control”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in knowledge, self-control]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:7 (#4)

**τὴν ἀγάπην**

**“love”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **love** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [loving others]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:7 (#2)

**τὴν φιλαδελφίαν & τῇ φιλαδελφίᾳ**

**“brotherly affection & brotherly affection”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **brotherly affection** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [being concerned for your brothers and sisters ... being concerned for your brothers and sisters]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:7 (#3)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ φιλαδελφίᾳ τὴν ἀγάπην**

**“and in brotherly affection, love”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in brotherly affection, love]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:7 (#1)

**ἐν δὲ τῇ εὐσεβείᾳ τὴν φιλαδελφίαν**

**“and in godliness, brotherly affection”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and supply in godliness, brotherly affection]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#4)

**οὐκ ἀργοὺς οὐδὲ ἀκάρπους καθίστησιν**

**“cause you to be neither barren nor unfruitful”**

Peter speaks of a person who does not possess these qualities as if he were a field that will not produce a crop. If that is confusing in your language, you could use a different metaphor with that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [cause you to be neither unproductive nor useless]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#5)

**οὐκ ἀργοὺς οὐδὲ ἀκάρπους καθίστησιν**

**“cause you to be neither barren nor unfruitful”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in positive terms. Alternate translation: [cause you to produce and bear fruit]

See: Double Negatives

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#1)

**ταῦτα γὰρ ὑμῖν ὑπάρχοντα καὶ πλεονάζοντα**

**“For these things existing and increasing in you”**

The word **For** here indicates that Peter is giving a reason why his audience should obey the command given in 1:5–7. Alternate translation: [Because these things existing and increasing in you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#2)

**ταῦτα γὰρ ὑμῖν ὑπάρχοντα καὶ πλεονάζοντα, οὐκ ἀργοὺς οὐδὲ ἀκάρπους καθίστησιν**

**"For these things existing and increasing in you cause you to be neither barren nor unfruitful"**

Peter is describing a conditional situation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express it that way. Alternate translation: [For if these things are existing and increasing in you, then they will cause you to be neither barren nor unfruitful]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#3)

**ταῦτα**

**"these things"**

Here, **these things** refers back to the faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#6)

**οὐκ ἀργοὺς οὐδὲ ἀκάρπους**

**"neither barren nor unfruitful"**

The words **barren** and **unfruitful** mean basically the same thing. In combination with the negatives **neither** and **nor**, they are used together to emphasize that this person will not be unproductive but will experience great benefits from knowing Jesus. If it is confusing in your language to use two words together that mean the same thing, you could just use one word with that meaning. Alternate translation: [not unproductive]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 1:8 (#7)

**εἰς τὴν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, ἐπίγνωσιν**

**"in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **knowledge** using a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [in your knowing our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#5)

**τυφλός ἐστιν μυωπάζων**

**"he & is blind, nearsighted"**

Although the words **blind** and **nearsighted** have similar meanings, **blind** is more extreme than **nearsighted**, and a person cannot be both at the same time. If it is confusing in your language to describe someone using both of these words in this way, you could use a word like "or" between them or show how they might work together. Alternate translation: [he ... is blind or nearsighted] or [he ... is blindly nearsighted] or [he ... is so nearsighted that he is blind to what is spiritually important]

See: Hendiadys

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#8)

**τοῦ καθαρισμοῦ τῶν πάλαι αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτιῶν**

**"of the cleansing of his past sins"**

Peter is speaking of forgiving sin as if sin were something that made people dirty and thus required **cleansing** from God. Alternate translation: [of the forgiving of his past sins]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

**For** indicates that Peter is giving another reason why his audience should obey the command given in 1:5–7. Peter gave a positive reason in 1:8 and gives a negative reason here. Alternate translation: [Because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#6)

**λήθην λαβὼν τοῦ καθαρισμοῦ**

**"having received forgetfulness of the cleansing"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **forgetfulness** in this phrase with a verb. Alternate translation: [having forgotten the cleansing]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#3)

**ταῦτα**

**"these things"**

The phrase **these things** refers back to the faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love, which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#4)

**τυφλός ἐστιν μυωπάζων**

**“he & is blind, nearsighted”**

In this metaphor, Peter speaks of a person who does not possess these qualities as if the person were **blind** or **nearsighted**. He means this in a spiritual sense, that this person cannot see what is spiritually important. If that is confusing in your language, you could use a different metaphor with that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he ... is like a blind or shortsighted person who cannot see their importance]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#7)

**τοῦ καθαρισμοῦ τῶν πάλαι αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτιῶν**

**“of the cleansing of his past sins”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **cleansing** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [that God has cleansed him from his old sins]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:9 (#2)

**ᾧ & μὴ πάρεστιν ταῦτα, τυφλός ἐστιν**

**“he in whom these things are not present is blind”**

Here, **he** does not refer to a specific person, but to any person who does not have these things. Alternate translation: [anyone who does not have these things]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#8)

**οὐ μὴ πταίσητέ ποτε**

**“you will certainly not ever stumble”**

Here, **stumble** could mean: (1) abandoning faith in Christ. Alternate translation: [you will certainly not abandon faith in Christ]; (2) committing sin. Alternate translation: [you will certainly not practice sinful behavior]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#2)

**ἀδελφοί**

**“brothers”**

Peter is using the term **brothers** as a way to directly address his fellow believers in Jesus. See the UST.

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#3)

**ἀδελφοί**

**“brothers”**

Peter is using the term **brothers** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Be sure that this is clear in your translation so that your readers do not get the impression that Peter is addressing only men. If you use a word such as “believers” to translate the metaphor **brothers**, you may need to use both the masculine and the feminine forms of that word in your language. If you retain the metaphor, you could state “my brothers and sisters.”

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#4)

**βεβαίαν ὑμῶν τὴν κλῆσιν καὶ ἐκλογὴν ποιεῖσθαι**

**“to make your calling and election sure”**

The words **calling** and **election** share similar meanings and both refer to God choosing believers to belong to him. Peter uses them together to emphasize this idea. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use just one word and provide the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [make sure that God has really chosen you to belong to him]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#5)

**ταῦτα γὰρ ποιοῦντες**

**“for doing these things”**

Here, **these things** refers back to the faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#1)

**διὸ**

**“Therefore”**

Peter uses **Therefore** to introduce a description of what his readers should do as a result of what he has just said. He is referring specifically to the two reasons for obedience given in 1:8–9. Alternate translation: [Because of these reasons]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#6)

**ταῦτα γὰρ ποιοῦντες οὐ μὴ πταίσητέ ποτε**

**"for doing these things, you will certainly not ever stumble"**

Peter is describing a conditional situation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express it that way. Alternate translation: [For if you do these things, then you will certainly not ever stumble]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

## 2 Peter 1:10 (#7)

**οὐ μὴ πταίσητέ ποτε**

**"you will certainly not ever stumble"**

The combination of the words **certainly not ever** here expresses strong emphatic negation. Alternate translation: [you will most certainly never stumble]

## 2 Peter 1:11 (#2)

**οὕτως**

**"in this way"**

Here, **in this way** refers back to the way of living that includes the faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love, which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:11 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

**For** indicates that Peter is giving a reason why his readers should want to obey the commands given in 1:5–7 and 1:10.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:11 (#4)

**εἰς τὴν αἰώνιον βασιλείαν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ**

**"into the eternal kingdom of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **kingdom** with a verbal phrase, such as "where our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ rules." Alternate translation: [into the eternal place where our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ rules]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:11 (#3)

**πλουσίως ἐπιχορηγηθήσεται ὑμῖν ἡ εἴσοδος εἰς τὴν αἰώνιον βασιλείαν**

**"will be richly provided to you the entrance into the eternal kingdom"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [God will richly provide to you the entrance into the eternal kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#2)

**τούτων**

**"these things"**

Here, **these things** refers back to what Peter has stated in the previous verses, specifically to faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love, which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#6)

**ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ**

**"in the present truth"**

Here, **present** is used as if **truth** were an object that could be there with Peter's audience. Here it does not refer to present time. Alternate translation: [in the truth that you have] or [in the truth that is with you]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#1)

**διὸ**

**"Therefore"**

## Connecting Statement:

Peter uses **Therefore** to introduce the purpose of his letter. In order to encourage his readers to do everything he has said in 1:5–10, and especially because of the promise in 1:11, he wants to keep reminding them about these things. Use a natural form in your language to show that this introduces a result or purpose for saying what came before. Alternate translation: [Because these things are very important]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#7)

**ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ**

**“in the present truth”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **truth** with an adjective, such as “true.” Alternate translation: [in these true teachings]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#4)

**ἐστηριγμένους ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ**

**“have been established in the present truth”**

Here, **established** is used to refer to one being firmly committed to something. Alternate translation: [you strongly believe the truth that you now have]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#3)

**ἐστηριγμένους ἐν**

**“have been established in”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [you learned well]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 1:12 (#5)

**ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ**

**“in the present truth”**

Here, **in** has the meaning of “in reference to” or “with regard to.” Alternate translation: [in reference to the present truth]

## 2 Peter 1:13 (#4)

**διεγείρειν ὑμᾶς ἐν ὑπομνήσει**

**“to arouse you in remembrance”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **remembrance** in this phrase with the verb “remind.” Alternate translation: [to remind you]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:13 (#3)

**διεγείρειν ὑμᾶς ἐν ὑπομνήσει**

**“to arouse you in remembrance”**

Peter uses **arouse** to refer to causing his readers to think about these things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this usage by translating this plainly. Alternate translation: [to remind you of these things so that you will think about them]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:13 (#2)

**ἐφ’ ὅσον εἰμὶ ἐν τούτῳ τῷ σκηνώματι**

**“as long as I am in this tent”**

Peter speaks of his body as if it were a **tent** that he is wearing and will take off. Being in his body represents being alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this directly. Alternate translation: [as long as I am in this body] or [as long as I live]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:13 (#1)

**δὲ**

**“But”**

**But** could mean: (1) Peter is contrasting what he just said in the previous verse with what he is about to say. His audience already knows the truth, but he wants to remind them again. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [Nevertheless.]; (2) Peter is connecting this statement with what he said at the beginning of the previous verse. Peter is always ready to remind them of the truth, and he thinks it is correct to do so. Alternate translation: [And]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

## 2 Peter 1:14 (#2)

**ταχινή ἐστιν ἡ ἀπόθεσις τοῦ σκηνώματός μου**

**“the putting off of my tent is imminent”**

Peter speaks of his body as if it were a **tent** that he is wearing and will take off. Being in his body represents being alive, and taking it off represents dying. Alternate translation: [I will soon take off this body]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:14 (#4)

**καθὼς καὶ ὁ Κύριος ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς, ἐδήλωσέν μοι**

**“just as also our Lord Jesus Christ revealed this to me”**

Suggested footnote: “Peter may be referring here to what Jesus told him, as recorded in John 21:18–19.”

## 2 Peter 1:14 (#3)

**ταχινή ἐστιν ἡ ἀπόθεσις τοῦ σκηνώματός μου**

**“the putting off of my tent is imminent”**

**Putting off** his **tent** is a nice way to refer to dying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this directly. Alternate translation: [I will die soon]

See: Euphemism

## 2 Peter 1:14 (#1)

**εἰδὼς**

**“knowing”**

In this clause Peter is giving a reason why he will always remind his audience of doctrinal truths in this letter, specifically faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love, which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7. Alternate translation: [This is because I know]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:15 (#3)

**τούτων**

**“of these things”**

Here, **these things** refers to what Peter has said in the previous verses, specifically the faith, goodness, knowledge, self-control, endurance, godliness, brotherly affection, and love which Peter mentioned in 1:5–7.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:15 (#4)

**μετὰ τὴν ἐμὴν ἔξοδον**

**“after my departure”**

Peter uses the word **departure** as a nice way to speak of his death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more common euphemism in your language, or state it directly. Alternate translation: [after my passing] or [after I die]

See: Euphemism

## 2 Peter 1:15 (#2)

**ἑκάστοτε, ἔχειν ὑμᾶς & τὴν τούτων μνήμην ποιεῖσθαι**

**“to cause you to always have the remembrance of these things”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **remembrance** in this phrase with the verb “remind.” Alternate translation: [to remind you of these things]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:15 (#1)

**δὲ καὶ**

**“Likewise”**

**Likewise** here could mean that: (1) this statement is in addition to what Peter just said in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Moreover]; (2) this statement is contrasting what he just said in the previous verse with what he is about to say. Alternate translation: [But]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#4)

**τὴν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δύναμιν καὶ παρουσίαν**

**“the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ”**

In this clause Peter refers to the second coming of the Lord Jesus to earth. This future event was foreshadowed by the powerful appearance of Jesus known as the “transfiguration,” which is described in Matthew 17:1–8, Mark 9:1–8, and Luke 9:28–36. Peter was an eyewitness of that event.

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#2)

**οὐ & ἐγνωρίσαμεν**

**“we did not make known”**

Here, **we** refers to Peter and the other apostles. It does not refer to his readers. Alternate translation: [we apostles did not follow]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#7)

**τῆς ἐκείνου μεγαλειότητος**

**“of the majesty of that one”**

The pronoun **that one** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [of the majesty of Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#5)

**τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ**

**“of our Lord Jesus Christ”**

Here, **our** refers to all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#8)

**τῆς ἐκείνου μεγαλειότητος**

**"of the majesty of that one"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **majesty** with an adjective such as "majestic." Alternate translation: [of his majestic nature]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#3)

**τὴν & δύναμιν καὶ παρουσίαν**

**"the power and coming"**

The words **power** and **coming** work together to refer to the same thing; they may be translated as a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the powerful coming]

See: Hendiadys

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

## Connecting Statement:

**For** indicates that in 1:16–21 Peter explains to the believers why they should remember "these things," which were mentioned in 1:5–7. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:16 (#6)

**ἐπόπται γενηθέντες**

**"by} having become eyewitnesses"**

This phrase indicates the means by which the apostles had made known to others the second coming of Jesus. The apostles based their teaching about the return of Jesus partly on their eyewitness experience. Alternate translation: [by means of becoming eyewitnesses]

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#4)

**φωνῆς ἐνεχθείσης αὐτῷ τοιᾶσδε ὑπὸ τῆς Μεγαλοπρεποῦς Δόξης**

**"such a voice having been brought to him by the Majestic Glory"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [when he heard that voice come to him from the Majestic Glory] or [when he heard the voice of the Majestic Glory speak to him] or [when the Majestic Glory spoke to him]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#5)

**φωνῆς ἐνεχθείσης αὐτῷ τοιᾶσδε ὑπὸ τῆς Μεγαλοπρεποῦς Δόξης**

**"such a voice having been brought to him by the Majestic Glory"**

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [such a voice having been brought to him by the Majestic Glory, and this is what God said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#9)

**μου & μου & ἐγὼ**

**"my & my & myself"**

The pronouns **my** and **myself** refer to God the Father, who is the one speaking in the quotation.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#3)

**λαβὼν & παρὰ Θεοῦ Πατρὸς τιμὴν καὶ δόξαν**

**"he has received honor and glory from God the Father"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **honor** and **glory** by translating them with equivalent expressions that use verbs. Alternate translation: [and God the Father honored and glorified him]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#2)

**παρὰ Θεοῦ Πατρὸς**

**"from God the Father"**

**Father** is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#8)

**ὁ Υἱός μου**

**“my Son”**

**Son** is an important title for Jesus, the Son of God.

See: Translating Son and Father

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**“For”**

Here, **For** indicates that what follows in 1:17–18 is the reason that Peter can say in the previous verse that he was an eyewitness to the majesty of Jesus. Use a connector that indicates that this is a reason or explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#6)

**ἐνεχθείσης αὐτῷ**

**“having been brought to him”**

The pronoun **him** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state explicitly the idea behind this connection. Alternate translation: [having been brought to Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:17 (#7)

**τῆς Μεγαλοπρεποῦς Δόξης**

**“the Majestic Glory”**

Peter refers to God in terms of his **Glory**. The glory of God is closely associated with God himself and here substitutes for his name. Alternate translation: [God, the Supreme Glory]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 1:18 (#5)

**τῷ ἁγίῳ ὄρει**

**“the holy mountain”**

The **mountain** Peter refers to is the mountain on which Jesus was powerfully transformed in the event known as the “transfiguration.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this information explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the holy mountain on which Jesus was powerfully transformed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:18 (#2)

**ἐξ οὐρανοῦ, ἐνεχθεῖσαν**

**“having been brought from heaven”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [having come from heaven] or [that came from heaven]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 1:18 (#1)

**ταύτην τὴν φωνὴν ἡμεῖς ἠκούσαμεν ἐξ οὐρανοῦ, ἐνεχθεῖσαν**

**“we ourselves heard this voice, having been brought from heaven”**

With the words **we ourselves**, Peter is referring to himself and to the disciples James and John, who also heard the voice of God. Alternate translation: [we, James, John, and I, heard this voice that came from heaven]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

## 2 Peter 1:18 (#3)

**σὺν αὐτῷ, ὄντες**

**“being with him”**

This is a temporal phrase that can begin with “when.” Alternate translation: [when we were with him]

## 2 Peter 1:18 (#4)

**σὺν αὐτῷ**

**“with him”**

Here, **him** refers to Jesus, not God the Father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this reference explicitly. Alternate translation: [being with Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#1)

**ἔχομεν βεβαιότερον τὸν προφητικὸν λόγον**

**“we have the very certain prophetic word”**

The word translated as **very certain** could refer to: (1) something that is extremely reliable. In this case, Peter is saying in 1:18–19 that we have two reliable witnesses to Jesus’ glory: God’s own voice speaking on the mountain of transfiguration and the extremely reliable prophetic scriptures. Alternate translation: [We also have the most reliable prophetic word]; (2) something that is confirmed by something else. In this case, Peter is saying that God’s voice on the mountain confirms, or makes even more trustworthy,

the prophetic scripture that we already trusted completely. Alternate translation: [we have the prophetic word confirmed]

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#8)

**φωσφόρος ἀνατείλῃ ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ὑμῶν**

**"the morning star might rise in your hearts"**

Peter speaks of Christ as the **morning star**, which is a star that indicates daybreak and the end of the night. Christ will **rise** by bringing light into the hearts of believers, ending all doubt and bringing full understanding of who he is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly or change the metaphor to a simile. Alternate translation: [Christ brings full understanding to you like the morning star shines its light into the world]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#7)

**ἕως οὗ ἡμέρα διαυγάσῃ**

**"until the day might dawn"**

Peter speaks of Christ's second coming by calling it the new **day** that comes in the morning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [until the day Christ returns]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#5)

**ᾧ καλῶς ποιεῖτε προσέχοντες**

**"to which you do well to pay attention"**

Peter uses the statement **you do well** to tell his audience that they should pay attention to the Old Testament Scriptures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this phrase by translating this phrase as a suggestion or command. Alternate translation: [to which you should pay attention]

See: Statements — Other Uses

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#6)

**ὡς λύχνῳ φαίνοντι ἐν αὐχμηρῷ τόπῳ**

**"as to a lamp shining in a dark place"**

Peter compares the prophetic word to a **lamp** that gives light in the darkness. Just as a lamp gives light in order for someone to see in **a dark place**, so the prophetic word gives believers guidance for how to live properly in this sin-filled world. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this simile plainly. Alternate translation: [a guide for you to know how to live in this world]

See: Simile

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#9)

**ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ὑμῶν**

**"in your hearts"**

Here, **hearts** is a metonym for people's minds. Alternate translation: [in your minds] or [to help you understand]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#2)

**ἔχομεν**

**"we have"**

Here, **we** refers to all believers, including Peter and his readers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#4)

**ᾧ καλῶς ποιεῖτε προσέχοντες**

**"to which you do well to pay attention"**

Here the relative pronoun **which** refers to the prophetic word mentioned in the previous phrase. Peter instructs the believers to pay close attention to the prophetic message, which is the Old Testament.

See: Pronouns

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#3)

**βεβαιότερον τὸν προφητικὸν λόγον**

**"the very certain prophetic word"**

Peter uses the phrase **prophetic word** to refer to the entire Old Testament. It does not refer only to those Old Testament books called "the Prophets," nor only to the predictive prophecies within the Old Testament. Alternate translation: [the Scriptures, which the prophets spoke]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:19 (#10)

**φωσφόρος**

**"the morning star"**

The **morning star** refers to the planet Venus, which is sometimes visible in the sky just before the sun rises,

thus indicating that daybreak is near. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make this information more explicit. Alternate translation: [the star that appears just before the sun rises]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 1:20 (#1)

**τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες**

**"knowing this first"**

Peter uses **first** here to refer to the degree of importance. It does not to refer to order in time. Alternate translation: [Most importantly, you must understand]

## 2 Peter 1:20 (#3)

**πᾶσα προφητεία Γραφῆς ἰδίας ἐπιλύσεως οὐ γίνεται**

**"every prophecy of scripture does not come from one's own interpretation"**

Here, **one's own interpretation** could mean: (1) that the Old Testament prophets did not base any of their prophecies on their own interpretations of what God had said, but only prophesied what God revealed to them. If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of information. Alternate translation: [no prophet interpreted his prophecy according to his own interpretation]; (2) that no individual person can interpret scripture on his or her own, but only with the help of the Holy Spirit and the larger community of believers. Alternate translation: [no one is able to explain any prophecy in the Bible through his own ability]

See: Information Structure

## 2 Peter 1:20 (#4)

**ἰδίας ἐπιλύσεως**

**"from one's own interpretation"**

The word **interpretation** is an abstract noun that represents an action. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with a verb. Alternate translation: [no prophet interpreted his prophecy according to what he himself thought]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:20 (#2)

**τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες**

**"knowing this first"**

Peter is using a statement to give an instruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this by translating it as a command. If you do so, it might be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Above all, know this]

See: Statements — Other Uses

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#3)

**οὐ & θελήματι ἀνθρώπου ἠνέχθη προφητεία ποτέ**

**"no prophecy was ever brought by the will of man"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **will** with a verbal phrase, such as "what a man desires." Alternate translation: [no prophecy was ever made according to what a man desires]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

**For** indicates that what follows is the reason that the statement of the previous verse is true. It could mean: (1) the prophets could not prophesy according to their own interpretations, because true prophecy could only come from the Holy Spirit. (2) no one can interpret prophecy without help from the Holy Spirit, because the prophecy came from the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [The reason for this is that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#2)

**οὐ & θελήματι ἀνθρώπου ἠνέχθη προφητεία ποτέ**

**"no prophecy was ever brought by the will of man"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [no prophet ever prophesied by the will of man] or [the will of man never produced any prophecy]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#5)

**ὑπὸ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου φερόμενοι, ἐλάλησαν ἀπὸ Θεοῦ ἄνθρωποι**

**"men being carried along by the Holy Spirit spoke from God"**

Peter speaks of the **Holy Spirit** helping the prophets to write what God wanted them to write as if the Holy Spirit **carried** them from one place to another. Alter-

nate translation: [men spoke from God by the Holy Spirit directing them]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#6)

**ἐλάλησαν ἀπὸ Θεοῦ**

**"spoke from God"**

In this phrase, Peter is leaving out a word that it would need in many languages in order to be complete. If this word is required in your language, it can be supplied from earlier in the verse. Alternate translation: [spoke prophecy from God]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 1:21 (#4)

**θελήματι ἀνθρώπου**

**"by the will of man"**

Peter is using the term **man** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [by human desire]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

## 2 Peter - Chapter 2 Introduction

### Structure and Formatting

1. Prediction of false teachers (2:1–3)
2. Examples of divine judgment (2:4–10a)
3. Description and denunciation of false teachers (2:10b–22)

Peter continues this letter in 2:1–3 by predicting that false teachers will try to deceive the believers, just as false prophets did during the time true prophets were writing the Old Testament. Then in 2:4–10a Peter describes examples of God punishing those who acted similarly to the coming false teachers. Peter then closes this section in 2:10b–22 by describing the wicked character and deeds of these false teachers.

### Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

#### Flesh

"Flesh" is a metaphor for a person's sinful nature. It is not the physical part of man that is sinful. "Flesh" represents the human nature that rejects all things godly and desires what is sinful. This is the condition of all humans before they receive the Holy Spirit by believing in Jesus.

#### Implicit information

There are several analogies in 2:4–8 that are difficult to understand if the Old Testament has not yet been translated. Further explanation may be necessary. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#3)

**αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας**

**"heresies of destruction"**

Here, **heresies** refers to opinions that are contrary to the teaching of Christ and the apostles. Alternate translation: [opinions of destruction]

See: Translate Unknowns

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#11)

**ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν**

**"bringing swift destruction on themselves"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **destruction** with a verb, such as "destroy." Alternate translation: [they are causing themselves to be destroyed soon]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#7)

**τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς Δεσπότην**

**"the master who bought them"**

Here, **master** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [master Jesus who bought them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#8)

**τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς Δεσπότην**

**"the master who bought them"**

Peter uses the phrase **the master who bought** to speak of Jesus as the owner of the people he has saved from damnation by paying the penalty for their sins with his death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [Jesus who saved them]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#5)

**αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας**

**"heresies of destruction"**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe an opinion that is characterized by **destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the adjective "destructive" instead of the noun "destruction." Alternate translation: [destructive heresies]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#1)

**δὲ**

**"Now"**

The term translated **Now** could refer to: (1) a new topic expressed by **Now** in the ULT. (2) a contrast between the false prophets in this clause and the true Old Testament prophets mentioned in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [But]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#10)

**ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν**

**"swift destruction"**

Here, **swift** could mean: (1) their destruction will come soon. Alternate translation: [destruction that will happen soon] or [imminent destruction]; (2) their destruction will be sudden or quick. Alternate translation: [quick destruction]

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#6)

**αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας**

**"heresies of destruction"**

Here, **destruction** could refer to: (1) the eternal damnation of those who teach or accept these **heresies**. Alternate translation: [heresies that result in their eternal damnation]; (2) the destruction of the faith of those who teach or accept these **heresies**. Alternate translation: [heresies that destroy their faith in the Messiah]

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#2)

**ἐν τῷ λαῷ**

**"among the people"**

Here, **the people** refers specifically to the Israelites. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel] or [the Israelites]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#9)

**ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν**

**"bringing swift destruction on themselves"**

Here, **bringing** indicates that this clause is the result of the deeds of the false teachers described in the previous clauses. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make a new sentence here and state this connection plainly. Alternate translation: [As a result, they are bringing swift destruction on themselves.]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:1 (#4)

**αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας**

**"heresies of destruction"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **destruction** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [destructive heresies] or [heresies that destroy]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#9)

**ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας βλασφημηθήσεται**

**"the way of truth will be slandered"**

Peter speaks of **the way of truth** as if it were a person who could be **slandered** or shown disrespect. Alternate translation: [they will say bad things about the way of truth]

See: Personification

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#1)

**πολλοὶ**

**"many"**

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate explicitly, as the UST does, that **many** refers to people.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#5)

**δι' οὓς**

**"because of whom"**

Here, **whom** refers to the false teachers. It does not refer to the licentious acts in the previous clause. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate explicitly, as the UST does, that this refers to the false

teachers. Alternate translation: [through these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#7)

**ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας**

**“the way of truth”**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that is characterized by **truth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the adjective “true” instead of the noun “truth.” Alternate translation: [the true way]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#2)

**ἐξακολουθήσουσιν**

**“will follow”**

Here Peter uses the word **follow** to refer to someone imitating the actions of someone else, like someone who walks behind another person in the same direction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [will imitate their licentious acts]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#10)

**ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας βλασφημηθήσεται**

**“the way of truth will be slandered”**

Peter assumes that his audience will know that unbelievers will be the ones who slander the Christian faith when they see the sensual lives of the false teachers and their followers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the way of truth will be slandered by unbelievers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#4)

**ταῖς ἀσελγείαις**

**“licentious acts”**

Here, **licentious acts** refers to immoral sexual actions that demonstrate a lack of self-control. Alternate translation: [uncontrolled sensual acts]

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#3)

**αὐτῶν ταῖς ἀσελγείαις**

**“their licentious acts”**

Here the pronoun **their** refers to the false teachers introduced in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the licentious acts of these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#8)

**ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας βλασφημηθήσεται**

**“the way of truth will be slandered”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and say who will do the action. Alternate translation: [unbelievers will slander the way of truth]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:2 (#6)

**ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας**

**“the way of truth”**

Peter uses the phrase **the way of truth** here to refer to the Christian faith or how a Christian person lives his or her life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [the true Christian manner of living] or [the true Christian faith]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#8)

**οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει**

**“for whom condemnation from long ago is not idle, and their destruction does not sleep”**

These two long phrases mean basically the same thing and emphasize that the false teachers will certainly be condemned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [their destruction from long ago is certain]

See: Parallelism

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#1)

**ἐν πλεονεξίᾳ**

**“in greed”**

Here, **in** indicates the reason for what the false teachers do. Alternate translation: [because of greed]

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#10)

**τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει**

**“condemnation from long ago is not idle, and their destruction does not sleep”**

Peter speaks of **condemnation** and **destruction** as if they are people who can be **idle** or **sleep**. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [condemnation from long ago is not ineffective, and their destruction is not delayed]

See: Personification

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#5)

**ἐμπορεύσονται**

**“they will exploit”**

Here, **they** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers will exploit you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#9)

**οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει**

**“for whom condemnation from long ago is not idle, and their destruction does not sleep”**

You can translate these phrases with verbs in positive terms. Alternate translation: [their condemnation from long ago is active, and their destruction is awake]

See: Double Negatives

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#11)

**οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει**

**“for whom condemnation from long ago is not idle, and their destruction does not sleep”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns “condemnation” and “destruction” by stating the ideas behind them with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [they are not idly condemned from long ago, and they will not be destroyed too late]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#4)

**πλαστοῖς λόγοις**

**“with false words”**

Peter is using the term **words** to describe the teachings of the false teachers that were conveyed by using **words**. Alternate translation: [by false teachings]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#7)

**οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ**

**“for whom condemnation from long ago is not idle”**

Here, **for whom** indicates that the condemnation is directed again the false teachers. Alternate translation: [against whom condemnation from long ago is not idle]

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#2)

**ἐν πλεονεξίᾳ**

**“in greed”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **greed** by translating the idea behind it with an adjective, such as “greedy.” Alternate translation: [because they are greedy]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#3)

**πλαστοῖς λόγοις**

**“with false words”**

Here, **false words** are the means by which the false teachers will exploit their victims. Alternate translation: [by means of false words]

## 2 Peter 2:3 (#6)

**οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ**

**“for whom condemnation from long ago is not idle”**

Here, **whom** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [condemnation from long ago is not idle for these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#7)

**ταρταρώσας**

**“throwing down to Tartarus”**

The word **Tartarus** is a term from Ancient Greek religion that refers to the place where evil spirits and wicked men who have died are punished. Some Ancient Jewish literature written in Greek uses **Tartarus** as a term for the place where God punishes the wicked. Alternate translation: [he cast them into hell]

See: How to Translate Names

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

**For** indicates here that Peter is giving the reason for the result he implicitly described in the previous verse. He is saying why the destruction of the false teachers is certain. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#13)

**εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους**

**"those being kept for judgment"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active verbal form and you can indicate who is doing the action. Alternate translation: [those whom God is keeping for judgment]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#4)

**ἀγγέλων ἁμαρτησάντων**

**"angels who had sinned"**

Peter uses **who had sinned** to distinguish the angels who were punished by God from those that were not.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#5)

**σειροῖς ζόφου**

**"in chains of darkness"**

Some of the best ancient manuscripts read "pits" instead of "chains." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it has. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading in the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#9)

**παρέδωκεν**

**"he handed over"**

Here, Peter speaks of God imprisoning the angels who sinned like someone who has **handed over** a criminal to the prison guards for imprisonment. Alternate translation: [imprisoned]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#12)

**εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους**

**"those being kept for judgment"**

This phrase refers to the sinful angels mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those sinful angels who are being kept for judgment]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#3)

**οὐκ ἐφείσατο**

**"did not spare"**

Here, **spare** means "to refrain from punishing." Alternate translation: [did not refrain from punishing]

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#6)

**σειροῖς ζόφου**

**"in chains of darkness"**

This phrase could refer to: (1) chains in a very dark place. Alternate translation: [in chains in darkness]; (2) a very deep darkness that imprisons them like chains. Alternate translation: [bound in darkness like chains]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#11)

**εἰς κρίσιν**

**"for judgment"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **judgment** by translating it with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [to be judged]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#10)

**εἰς κρίσιν**

**"for judgment"**

This phrase gives the purpose or goal for which the sinning angels are being held in captivity. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of judgment]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#8)

**παρέδωκεν**

**"he handed over"**

God is the one who **handed over** the angels who had sinned. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make that explicit in your translation. Alternate translation: [God handed over]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:4 (#2)

**εἰ**

**"if"**

## Connecting Statement:

Here, **if** indicates the beginning of a conditional sentence that extends from 2:4 to 2:10. Peter is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Peter is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since God did not spare the angels who had sinned]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#1)

**καὶ**

**"and"**

Here, **and** indicates the beginning of the second condition in a conditional sentence that extends from 2:4 to 2:10. Peter is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Peter is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#8)

**δικαιοσύνης κήρυκα**

**"a preacher of righteousness"**

Peter could be using the possessive form to refer to: (1) a preacher who is characterized by righteousness. Alternate translation: [a preacher who is righteous]; (2) a preacher who tells others to live righteously. Alternate translation: [one who urged others to live righteously]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#6)

**Νῶε, δικαιοσύνης κήρυκα**

**"Noah, a preacher of righteousness"**

This phrase gives us more information about Noah. It tells us that Noah proclaimed **righteousness** to the ungodly people of the ancient world. It does not distinguish this Noah from any other person named Noah.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#7)

**δικαιοσύνης κήρυκα**

**"a preacher of righteousness"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **righteousness** with an equivalent expression. In this context, the term refers righteous deeds. Alternate translation: [a preacher of righteous deeds] or [a preacher of how to act rightly]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#4)

**οὐκ ἐφείσατο**

**"he did not spare"**

Here, **he** refers to God. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God did not spare]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#9)

**κατακλυσμὸν κόσμῳ ἀσεβῶν ἐπάξας**

**"having brought a flood upon the world of the ungodly ones"**

This clause indicates when God protected Noah and his other seven family members, when he **brought a flood upon the world**, as it is translated in the UST.

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#5)

**ὄγδοον, Νῶε**

**“the eighth, Noah”**

Here, **eighth** is an idiom used to refer to a group of eight people. It means that Noah was one of only eight people in the ancient world whom God did not destroy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the literal meaning of the idiom. Alternate translation: [eight people, including Noah] or [with seven others, Noah]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#2)

**ἀρχαίου κόσμου οὐκ ἐφείσατο**

**“he did not spare the ancient world”**

Here, **world** refers to the people who lived in it. Alternate translation: [he did not spare the people who lived in the ancient times]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#3)

**οὐκ ἐφείσατο**

**“he did not spare”**

As in 2:4, the word **spare** here means “to refrain from punishing.” Alternate translation: [did not refrain from punishing]

## 2 Peter 2:5 (#10)

**κόσμῳ ἀσεβῶν**

**“upon the world of the ungodly ones”**

Peter could be using the possessive form to refer to: (1) the human content of the ancient world. Alternate translation: [the world that contained ungodly people]; (2) the world as being characterized by ungodliness. Alternate translation: [the ungodly world]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#1)

**καὶ**

**“and”**

Here, **and** indicates the beginning of the third condition in a conditional sentence that extends from 2:4 to 2:10. Peter is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Peter is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#2)

**καὶ πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν**

**“and the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah, having reduced to ashes, he condemned to destruction”**

If it would be natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [and he condemned the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to destruction, having reduced them to ashes]

See: Information Structure

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#4)

**καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν**

**“he condemned to destruction”**

Here, **he** refers to God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [God condemned them to destruction]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#7)

**ἀσεβέσιν**

**“to the ungodly ones”**

Here, **ungodly** refers to wicked people in general, not to one specific wicked person. Alternate translation: [to an ungodly person] or [to ungodly people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#5)

**καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν**

**“he condemned to destruction”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **destruction** by translating the idea behind it with an verb, such as “destroy.” Alternate translation: [he condemned them to be destroyed]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#6)

**ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντων ἀσεβέσιν τεθεικώς**

**“having set an example {of the things that} are going to happen to the ungodly ones”**

This clause indicates the result of what happened in the previous clauses of the verse. God’s destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah resulted in them being an **example** and a warning of what happens to others who disobey God. Alternate translation: [with the result that God set them as an example of the things that will happen to the ungodly]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:6 (#3)

**πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας**

**“the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah, having reduced to ashes”**

This phrase indicates the means by which God destroyed **Sodom and Gomorrah**. Alternate translation: [by means of reducing the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to ashes]

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#3)

**καταπονούμενον ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς**

**“being oppressed by the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness”**

## Connecting Statement:

This clause is giving more information about **Lot**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could begin a new sentence here to clarify this. Alternate translation: [He was being oppressed by the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#9)

**τῶν ἀθέσμων**

**“of the lawless ones”**

Here, **the lawless ones** refers to the people who lived in the city of Sodom, where Lot lived. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [of the lawless people of Sodom] or [of the people who act as if there is no law in Sodom]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#8)

**τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς**

**“the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the abstract noun **licentiousness** with an adjective. See how you translated the plural form of this term in 2:2. Alternate translation: [the licentious behavior of the lawless ones] or [the wild sensual behavior of the lawless ones]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#7)

**τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς**

**“the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness”**

Here, **in** indicates the content of what the lawless people were doing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate **in licentiousness** with an adjective. Alternate translation: [the licentious behavior of the lawless ones]

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#4)

**καταπονούμενον ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς**

**“being oppressed by the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness oppressed him]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#5)

**ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς**

**“by the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness”**

Here, **by** could refer to: (1) the thing that was oppressing Lot, as in the ULT. (2) the reason why Lot was oppressed. Alternate translation: [because of the behavior of the lawless ones in licentiousness]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#1)

**καὶ**

**“and”**

## Connecting Statement:

Here, **and** indicates the beginning of the fourth condition in a conditional sentence that extends from 2:4 to 2:10. Peter is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Peter is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#6)

**ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων & ἀναστροφῆς**

**"by the behavior of the lawless ones"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the abstract noun **behavior** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [by what the lawless ones did] or [by how the lawless ones acted]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:7 (#2)

**ἐρύσατο**

**"he rescued"**

Here, **he** refers to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [God rescued]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"for"**

Peter uses **for** here to provide background information about Lot's life in Sodom. This is to help readers understand why Peter called Lot a righteous person in the previous verse. Peter is not using **for** here to indicate result. Use the natural form in your language for introducing background information. Alternate translation: [now]

See: Background Information

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#8)

**ἀνόμοις ἔργοις**

**"by lawless works"**

This phrase could mean: (1) the **lawless works** were the means by which Lot tormented his soul. Alternate translation: [with lawless works]; (2) the **lawless works** were the reason why Lot tormented his soul. Alternate translation: [because of lawless works]

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#4)

**ἐνκατοικῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς**

**"living among them"**

This clause indicates the time when Lot dwelled in Sodom. Alternate translation: [when he lived among them]

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#6)

**ἐνκατοικῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς ἡμέραν ἐξ ἡμέρας**

**"living among them day from day"**

This phrase, **day from day**, is an idiom meaning "day after day" or "every day." You may need to express this literally in your language. Alternate translation: [living among them day after day] or [living among them every day]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#5)

**αὐτοῖς**

**"them"**

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to the inhabitants of Sodom. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could specify what the pronoun **them** refers to. Alternate translation: [the people of Sodom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#7)

**ψυχὴν δικαίαν & ἐβασάνιζεν**

**"was tormenting his righteous soul"**

Here, **soul** refers to Lot's thoughts and emotions. The immoral behavior of the citizens of Sodom and Gomorrah disturbed him emotionally. Alternate translation: [was greatly disturbed]

See: Synecdoche

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#2)

**βλέμματι γὰρ καὶ ἀκοῇ**

**"for, by seeing and by hearing"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the abstract nouns **seeing** and **hearing** with verbal phrases. Alternate translation: [for by what he saw and what he heard]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:8 (#3)

**ὁ δίκαιος**

**“that righteous {man”**

This refers to Lot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [righteous Lot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#7)

**ἡμέραν κρίσεως**

**“the day of judgment”**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe a **day** that is characterized by **judgment**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase to explain it. Alternate translation: [the day when God judges mankind]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#1)

**οἶδεν Κύριος**

**“the Lord knows how”**

This verse and the next verse are the end of a conditional sentence that extends from 2:4 to 2:10. Peter is giving the result of the previous conditions being true. If you have made 2:4–10 into separate sentences, then you will need to indicate that 2:9 is the result of the previous conditions being true. Alternate translation: [Therefore, it is true that the Lord knows how] or [Since these things are true, it is also true that the Lord knows how]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#2)

**ἀδίκους δὲ εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως κολαζομένους τηρεῖν**

**“and to keep the unrighteous ones to be punished in the day of judgment”**

Here, **and** could refer to: (1) a contrast between the previous clause and what follows, as in the ULT and UST. (2) a simple connection between the previous clause and what follows. Alternate translation: [and to keep the unrighteous ones to be punished in the day of judgment]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#5)

**ἀδίκους & κολαζομένους τηρεῖν**

**“to keep the unrighteous ones to be punished”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [to keep the unrighteous ones to punish them]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#6)

**εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως**

**“in the day of judgment”**

Here, **in** could refer to: (1) when the unrighteous ones will be punished. Alternate translation: [on the day of judgment]; (2) the point in time up to which the unrighteous ones will be punished. Alternate translation: [until the day of judgment]

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#4)

**κολαζομένους**

**“to be punished”**

This is a purpose clause. Peter is stating the purpose for which God is keeping the unrighteous people. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [in order to be punished]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:9 (#3)

**πειρασμοῦ & ἀδίκους δὲ εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως κολαζομένους τηρεῖν**

**“a trial, and to keep the unrighteous ones to be punished in the day of judgment”**

In this clause, Peter is leaving out some words that it would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [a trial and the Lord knows how to keep the unrighteous ones to be punished in the day of judgment]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#6)

**καὶ κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας**

**“and despising authority”**

Here, **and** indicates that this clause provides an additional characteristic of those mentioned in the previous clause. It does not indicate a second group of wicked people. These wicked people not only pursue

their sinful desires, but also despise authority. Alternate translation: [and who also despise authority]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#8)

**τολμηταὶ**

**“Audacious ones”**

**Audacious ones** marks the beginning of the second section of this chapter, which continues until the end of 2:22. In this section Peter describes the wicked character and deeds of the false teachers.

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#7)

**κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας**

**“despising authority”**

Here, **authority** could refer to: (1) God’s authority, as suggested from the examples of rebelling against God in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [despising God’s authority]; (2) angelic authority, as suggested by the insulting of “glorious ones” mentioned in the remainder of the verse. Alternate translation: [despising the authority of angels]

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#11)

**οὐ τρέμουσιν**

**“They do not tremble”**

Here, **They** refers to the false teachers Peter introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [These false teachers do not tremble]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#3)

**σαρκὸς**

**“the flesh”**

Here, **flesh** is used to refer to person’s sinful nature. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this figure of speech literally. Alternate translation: [their sinful nature]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#5)

**ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ**

**“in {its} lusts of defilement”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **defilement** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [in its lusts that defile]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#9)

**τολμηταὶ αὐθάδεις**

**“Audacious ones! Self-willed ones”**

The words **Audacious ones** and **Self-willed ones** are exclamations that emphasize the bold pride of the false teachers. Alternate translation: [They are so audacious and self-willed!] or [How audacious and self-willed they are!]

See: Exclamations

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#12)

**δόξας & βλασφημοῦντες**

**“while insulting glorious ones”**

This clause indicates the time when the false teachers do not tremble. Alternate translation: [when insulting glorious ones]

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#1)

**δὲ**

**“but”**

## Connecting Statement:

Here, **but** indicates a connection between the last clause of the previous verse and what follows. It does not indicate a contrast between “the unrighteous” in the previous verse and “those going after the flesh” in this verse. Alternate translation: [and especially those going after the flesh]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#2)

**τοὺς ὀπίσω & πορευομένους**

**“the ones going after”**

## Connecting Statement:

Peter uses the phrase **going after** to refer to habitually doing something. This expression is frequently used in the Bible to describe people worshiping false gods or engaging in sexual immorality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [those habitually engaging in]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#10)

**αὐθάδεις**

**“Self-willed ones”**

**Self-willed** means “doing whatever one wants to do.” Alternate translation: [Those who do whatever they want]

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#13)

**δόξας**

**“glorious ones”**

Here, **glorious ones** could refer to: (1) spiritual beings, such as angels, demons, or both. Alternate translation: [glorious spiritual beings]; (2) important human beings, such as church leaders. Alternate translation: [glorious people]

## 2 Peter 2:10 (#4)

**ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ**

**“in {its} lusts of defilement”**

Here, **in** indicates that this phrase shows the means by which the wicked people go after the flesh. Alternate translation: [by means of practicing its lusts of defilement]

## 2 Peter 2:11 (#2)

**ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες**

**“being greater in strength and power”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the surrounding context, which is a description of the false teachers. Alternate translation: [being greater in strength and power than these false teachers]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 2:11 (#3)

**ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες**

**“being greater in strength and power”**

The words **strength** and **power** mean similar things. Peter is using them together for emphasis. Together, the words describe extreme power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this pair of words with a single expression. Alternate translation: [being much more powerful]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 2:11 (#1)

**ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες**

**“being greater in strength and power”**

This clause could refer to: (1) a contrast between the description of the **angels** in this clause with their behavior in the next clause. Alternate translation: [despite being greater in strength and power]; (2) a description of the **angels**. Alternate translation: [who are greater in strength and power]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 2:11 (#4)

**οὐ φέρουσιν κατ’ αὐτῶν & βλάσφημον κρίσιν**

**“do not bring an insulting judgment against them”**

Here, **them** could mean: (1) the “glorious ones.” Alternate translation: [do not bring an insulting judgment against these glorious ones.]; (2) the false teachers. Alternate translation: [do not bring an insulting judgment against these false teachers.]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#13)

**ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν**

**“in their destruction”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **destruction** with a verb, such as “destroy.” Alternate translation: [when they are destroyed]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#1)

**οὗτοι**

**“these {men”**

Here, **these {men}** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. Alternate translation: [these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#7)

**ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν βλασφημοῦντες**

**“slandering about {those things} in which they are ignorant”**

This clause could refer to: (1) more information about the false teachers. Alternate translation: [who slander those things in which they are ignorant]; (2) the reason

the false teachers will be destroyed. Alternate translation: [because they slander those things in which they are ignorant]

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#6)

**εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν**

**“for capture and destruction”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **capture** and **destruction** by stating the ideas behind them with verbs. Alternate translation: [in order to capture and destroy them]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#10)

**καὶ φθαρήσονται**

**“they will also be destroyed”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can state who will do the action. Alternate translation: [God will also destroy them]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#12)

**ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν**

**“in their destruction”**

This clause indicates the time when the false teachers will be destroyed. Alternate translation: [at the time of their destruction]

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#8)

**ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν**

**“about {those things} in which they are ignorant”**

Here, **those things** could refer to: (1) the “glorious ones” of 2:10. Alternate translation: [who slander those of whom they are ignorant]; (2) the Christian teachings that these false teachers are rejecting. Alternate translation: [who slander the teachings of which they are ignorant]

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#11)

**καὶ φθαρήσονται**

**“they will also be destroyed”**

Here, **also** is used for emphasis and may be translated as “indeed” or “surely.” Alternate translation: [they will indeed be destroyed] or [they will surely be destroyed]

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#2)

**οὗτοι & ὡς ἄλογα ζῷα**

**“these {men}, as unreasoning animals”**

Peter describes the false teachers by comparing them to **unreasoning animals**. Just as **animals** cannot think rationally, neither can these people. Alternate translation: [these false teachers are like animals who are not capable of thinking rationally]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#4)

**γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν**

**“having by nature been born for capture and destruction”**

Here, **by nature** means that the unreasoning animals (and false teachers by comparison) were destined for capture and destruction due to their very nature as animals born for this purpose. Alternate translation: [according to their nature, these animals are born for capture and destruction]

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#9)

**ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν καὶ φθαρήσονται**

**“they will also be destroyed in their destruction”**

Here, the pronouns **they** and **their** refer to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers will also be destroyed in their destruction]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#5)

**εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν**

**“for capture and destruction”**

This is a purpose clause. The word **for** here indicates that what follows it is the purpose for which these animals have been born. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of capture and destruction]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:12 (#3)

**γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν**

**“having by nature been born for capture and destruction”**

This clause gives more information about the unreasoning animals and thus, by way of comparison, the

false teachers. Alternate translation: [which have by nature been born for capture and destruction]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#5)

**τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν**

**“the reveling in the day”**

This phrase indicates the time when the false teachers were **reveling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate **in** as “during.” Doing these things “during the day” indicates that these people are not ashamed of this behavior. Alternate translation: [reveling during the day]

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#6)

**σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι**

**“stains and blemishes”**

Peter speaks of the false teachers as if they were **stains** or **blemishes** on a garment that cause shame for those who wear it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating it as a simile. Alternate translation: [like stains and blemishes on clothes, which cause disgrace]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#1)

**ἀδικούμενοι μισθὸν ἀδικίας**

**“being harmed {as} wages of unrighteousness”**

Peter speaks of the punishment that the false teachers will receive as if it were a wage they had earned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [receiving the punishment they deserve for their unrighteousness]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#4)

**τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν**

**“the reveling in the day”**

Here, **reveling** refers to immoral activity that includes gluttony, drunkenness, and sexual activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this abstract noun by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [their ability to revel in the day]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#8)

**σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι**

**“stains and blemishes”**

For emphasis, here Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the context. Alternate translation: [They are stains and blemishes]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#9)

**ἐντρυφῶντες ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν**

**“reveling in their deceptions”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the abstract noun **deceptions** with an adjective like “deceptive.” Alternate translation: [reveling in their deceptive deeds]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#7)

**σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι**

**“stains and blemishes”**

The words **stains** and **blemishes** share similar meanings. Peter is using them together for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate them with a single expression. Alternate translation: [unsightly stains]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#2)

**ἀδικίας**

**“of unrighteousness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **unrighteousness** by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [of the wrong things they have done]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:13 (#3)

**ἡδονὴν**

**“pleasure”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **pleasure** by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [something that pleases]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#7)

**καρδίαν γεγυμνασμένην πλεονεξίας ἔχοντες**

**“having hearts trained in covetousness”**

Peter is using **hearts** to refer to whole persons, including their thoughts, desires, and emotions. The term can thus be translated here with the reflexive pronoun “themselves.” Alternate translation: [having trained themselves to covet]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#3)

**δελεάζοντες ψυχὰς ἀστηρίκτους**

**“enticing unstable souls”**

This clause refers to the actions of the false teachers Peter introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers entice unstable souls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#8)

**καρδίαν γεγυμνασμένην πλεονεξίας ἔχοντες**

**“having hearts trained in covetousness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **covetousness** with a verb. Alternate translation: [having training their hearts to covet]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#9)

**κατάρας τέκνα**

**“children of cursing”**

Peter is using a Hebrew idiom in which a person is said to be a “child” of the thing that characterizes that person. Here, **children of cursing** refers to people who are cursed by God. He is not speaking of people who curse others. Alternate translation: [accursed people]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#1)

**ὀφθαλμοὺς ἔχοντες μεστοὺς μοιχαλίδος**

**“having eyes full of an adulteress”**

Here, **eyes** refers to a person’s desires, and **eyes full** means that a person constantly desires one thing. Alternate translation: [constantly desiring an adulteress]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#2)

**ὀφθαλμοὺς ἔχοντες μεστοὺς μοιχαλίδος**

**“having eyes full of an adulteress”**

This clause could mean: (1) the false teachers constantly desired to have immoral sexual relations with any woman they saw, thereby viewing every women as a potential adulteress. Alternate translation: [constantly desiring women with whom to commit adultery]; (2) the false teachers were constantly looking for immoral women with whom to have immoral sexual relations. Alternate translation: [constantly seeking sexually immoral women]

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#6)

**καρδίαν γεγυμνασμένην πλεονεξίας ἔχοντες**

**“having hearts trained in covetousness”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [they trained their hearts to be covetous]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#10)

**κατάρας τέκνα**

**“children of cursing”**

These words are an exclamation that emphasizes the wickedness of the false teachers. Alternate translation: [They are such cursed children!] or [What cursed children they are!]

See: Exclamations

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#5)

**καρδίαν γεγυμνασμένην πλεονεξίας ἔχοντες**

**“having hearts trained in covetousness”**

This clause refers to the actions of the false teachers Peter introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they have hearts trained in covetousness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:14 (#4)

**δελεάζοντες ψυχὰς ἀστηρίκτους**

**“enticing unstable souls”**

Here, **souls** refers to persons. Alternate translation: [enticing unstable people]

See: Synecdoche

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#3)

**ἐπλανήθησαν**

**“they have gone astray”**

Here, Peter continues the path metaphor from the previous clause. He describes the wicked lifestyles of the false teachers as if they had been **led astray** from the straight path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly. Alternate translation: [they have been behaving wickedly]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#7)

**τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ**

**“of Balaam of Bosor”**

**Bosor** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#1)

**καταλειπόντες εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν**

**“Abandoning the straight way”**

Peter uses the metaphor **Abandoning the straight way** to give an image of walkers leaving a certain pathway. He speaks of the false teachers refusing to live their lives in obedience to the Lord as if they had stopped walking on the Lord’s path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [refusing to live in obedience to God]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#9)

**ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν**

**“who loved the wages of unrighteousness”**

Here, the pronoun **who** refers to Balaam. It does not refer to Bosor, nor to the false teachers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this directly. If you begin a new sentence, you will have to replace the comma with a period. Alternate translation: [Balaam loved the wages of unrighteousness]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#4)

**ἐπλανήθησαν**

**“they have gone astray”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [they went astray]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#5)

**ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ, ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν**

**“having followed the way of Balaam of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness”**

In this verse, Peter compares the false teachers to **Balaam**. Peter assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of Numbers. In that story, Balaam was hired by wicked kings to curse the Israelites. When God did not allow Balaam to do so, he used wicked women to seduce the Israelites into sexual immorality and idol worship so that God would punish them for their disobedience. Balaam did these wicked things because he wanted to be paid by the wicked kings, but he was eventually killed by the Israelites when they conquered the land of Canaan. You could indicate this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation, as a statement: [following the way of Balaam son of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness so much that he led the Israelites into immorality and idolatry in order to receive money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#6)

**ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ**

**“having followed the way of Balaam of Bosor”**

Here, Peter uses the word **followed** to refer to someone imitating the actions of someone else, like someone who walks behind another person in the same direction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [having imitated the way of Balaam son of Bosor]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#8)

**τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ**

**“the way of Balaam of Bosor”**

Here, Peter uses **the way of Balaam** to refer to how Balaam lived his life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [the manner of living of Balaam son of Bosor]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#11)

**μισθὸν ἀδικίας**

**“the wages of unrighteousness”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **unrighteousness** with the adjective “unrighteous.” Alternate translation: [the unrighteous wages] or [the wages for unrighteous acts]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#10)

**ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν**

**“who loved the wages of unrighteousness”**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe **wages** that are characterized by **unrighteousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase to explain it. Alternate translation: [who loved the unrighteous wages]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:15 (#2)

**εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν**

**“the straight way”**

Here, **the straight way** refers to the way of living life that is right and pleasing to the Lord. Peter may also be using it here to refer specifically to the Christian faith, similar to his use of “the way of truth” in 2:2. Alternate translation: [the right way of the Lord]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 2:16 (#5)

**ἐκώλυσεν τὴν τοῦ προφήτου παραφρονίαν**

**“restrained the irrationality of the prophet”**

Here, **the prophet** refers to Balaam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [restrained the madness of the prophet Balaam]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:16 (#3)

**ἰδίας παρανομίας**

**“for his own transgression”**

This **transgression** specifically refers to Balaam’s use of wicked women to lead the Israelites into sexual immorality and idolatry. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for his wicked act of leading the Israelites into immorality]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:16 (#1)

**ἔλεγξιν & ἔσχεν**

**“he had a rebuke”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **rebuke** as a verb and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [God rebuked him]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:16 (#4)

**τὴν τοῦ προφήτου παραφρονίαν**

**“the irrationality of the prophet”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **irrationality** with an adjective like “irrational” or “foolish.” Alternate translation: [the irrational action of the prophet] or [the foolish action of the prophet]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:16 (#2)

**ἔλεγξιν & ἔσχεν**

**“he had a rebuke”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could specify who rebuked Balaam. This clause could mean: (1) the donkey rebuked Balaam. Alternate translation: [a donkey rebuked him]; (2) God rebuked Balaam through the donkey. Alternate translation: [God rebuked him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#7)

**ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους**

**“the gloom of darkness”**

Here, Peter uses **gloom** and **darkness** to refer to hell. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this directly. Alternate translation: [for whom God has reserved the gloom of darkness of hell]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#5)

**οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται**

**“for whom the gloom of darkness has been reserved”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [for whom God has reserved the gloom of darkness]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#4)

**οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι, καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι**

**“These {men} are waterless springs and mists driven by a storm”**

These two metaphors mean similar things. Peter is using them together for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this connection by translating them with a single expression. Alternate translation: [These are men who surely never give what they promise] or [These are men who surely disappoint]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#3)

**ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι**

**“mists driven by a storm”**

Peter gives a second figurative description of the uselessness of the false teachers. When people see storm clouds, they expect rain to fall. When the winds from the **storm** blow the clouds away before the rain can fall, the people are disappointed. In the same way, false teachers, although they promise many things, are unable to do what they promise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly, or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [they never give what they promise] or [they are disappointing like rain clouds that the storm drives away]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#1)

**οὗτοί**

**“These {men”**

**These {men}** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [These false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#6)

**ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους**

**“the gloom of darkness”**

This could mean: (1) the **gloom** is characterized by **darkness**. Alternate translation: [the dark gloom]; (2) the **gloom** is identical to the **darkness**. Alternate translation: [the gloom, which is darkness.]

## 2 Peter 2:17 (#2)

**οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι**

**“These {men} are waterless springs”**

Peter speaks of the false teachers to describe their uselessness. People expect **springs** to provide water to quench thirst, but **waterless springs** leave thirsty people disappointed. In the same way, false teachers, although they promise many things, are unable to do what they promise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [These men are disappointing, like springs without water]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#7)

**ἀσελγείαις**

**“by licentious acts”**

Here, **licentious acts** refers to immoral sexual actions that demonstrate a lack of self-control. See how you translated this term in 2:2. Alternate translation: [uncontrolled sensual acts]

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**“For”**

Here, **For** indicates the reason why the false teachers are reserved for punishment in the gloom of darkness,

as mentioned in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [This is so because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#4)

**ματαιότητος**

**"of vanity"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **vanity** with an adjective, such as "vain."

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#5)

**δελεάζουσιν ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς**

**"they entice by lusts of the flesh"**

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers entice by the lusts of the flesh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#3)

**ὑπέρογκα & ματαιότητος**

**"arrogant things of vanity"**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe **arrogant** speech that is characterized by **vanity**. Alternate translation: [vain, arrogant things] or [vain and arrogant things]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#2)

**ὑπέρογκα & ματαιότητος φθεγγόμενοι**

**"speaking arrogant things of vanity"**

This clause indicates the means by which the false teachers entice others to sin. Alternate translation: [by means of speaking arrogant things of vanity]

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#8)

**τοὺς ὀλίγως ἀποφεύγοντας τοὺς ἐν πλάνῃ ἀναστρεφομένους**

**"the ones barely escaping from the ones living in error"**

Here, Peter speaks of people who recently became believers as **those barely escaping** from sinful humanity. He also refers to unbelievers who still live according to their sinful desires as **those living in error**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [people who recently ceased living sinfully as other people do]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:18 (#6)

**ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς**

**"by lusts of the flesh"**

Here, **flesh** is used to refer to a person's sinful nature. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the literal meaning for the metaphor. Alternate translation: [by the lusts of their sinful natures]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#8)

**ᾧ γάρ τις ἥττηται, τούτῳ δεδούλωται**

**"For by what someone has been overcome, by this he has been enslaved"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this passive sentence with an active form. Alternate translation: [For if something overpowers a person, that thing enslaves that person]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#5)

**δοῦλοι**

**"slaves"**

Peter speaks of people who live sinfully as if they were **slaves** to sin who need to escape from their captivity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [like slaves]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#4)

**αὐτοὶ δοῦλοι ὑπάρχοντες τῆς φθορᾶς**

**"while themselves being slaves of destruction"**

Peter uses the word **themselves** here to emphasize the irony of spiritually enslaved people promising spiritual freedom to others. Alternate translation: [while they themselves are slaves of destruction]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#6)

**δοῦλοι & τῆς φθορᾶς**

**“slaves of destruction”**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe **slaves** that are characterized by **destruction**. Alternate translation: [slaves that will be destroyed]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#2)

**ἐλευθερίαν αὐτοῖς ἐπαγγελλόμενοι**

**“promising freedom to them”**

Here, **freedom** is a metaphor for the ability to live exactly as one wants. Alternate translation: [promising to give them the ability to live exactly as they want to live]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#3)

**ἐλευθερίαν αὐτοῖς ἐπαγγελλόμενοι**

**“promising freedom to them”**

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to those people who are deceived by the false teachers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [promising freedom to those whom they deceive]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#7)

**ᾧ γάρ τις ἥττηται, τούτῳ δεδούλωται**

**“For by what someone has been overcome, by this he has been enslaved”**

Peter speaks of a person as being **enslaved** when anything has control over that person, he speaks of that thing as the master of that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or as a simile. Alternate translation: [For if a person is overpowered by something, that person becomes controlled by that thing] or [For if a person is overpowered by something, that person becomes like a slave to that thing]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:19 (#1)

**ἐλευθερίαν αὐτοῖς ἐπαγγελλόμενοι**

**“promising freedom to them”**

This clause refers to another means by which the false teachers enticed their followers, continuing from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [They also entice them by promising freedom to them]

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**“For”**

Here, **For** could refer to: (1) another explanation of Peter’s statement “themselves being slaves of destruction” in the previous verse, (2) a transition from what Peter said in the previous verse to what he is going to say in this verse. Here, **For** does not indicate the reason or result of what was said in the previous verse. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [And]

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#7)

**τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**“of our Lord and Savior”**

Here, **our Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.” The conjunction **and** indicates that **our** also applies to **Savior**, meaning “the person who saves us.” Alternate translation: [of the person who rules over us and saves us]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#8)

**τούτοις & πάλιν ἐμπλακέντες ἡττῶνται**

**“having been entangled again, they have been overcome by these things”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can supply the doer of the action from earlier in the verse. Alternate translation: [these things having entangled them again; these things have overcome them]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#3)

**εἰ & ἀποφυγόντες τὰ μιάσματα τοῦ κόσμου**

**“if, having escaped the defilements of the world”**

Using a similar metaphor to that in 2:18, here Peter speaks of believers as if they had been slaves to the **defilements** of the world and have **escaped** that captivity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [if they have ceased living in the defiling manner of the world]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#9)

**πάλιν ἐμπλακέντες**

**“having been entangled again”**

Here, Peter speaks of people who seem to have been believers but have returned to living sinfully as if they have become **entangled** in a net. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [if they have begun to live sinfully again]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#10)

**τούτοις**

**“by these things”**

Here, the pronoun **these things** refers to “the defilements of the world.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could specify this in your translation. Alternate translation: [by these defilements of the world]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#12)

**γέγονεν αὐτοῖς τὰ ἔσχατα χείρονα τῶν πρώτων**

**“for them the last things have become worse than the first things”**

Here, the adjectives **last** and **first** function as nouns. They are plural, and ULT supplies the noun **things** in each case to show that. If your language does not use adjectives in this way, you can supply a more specific singular noun. Alternate translation: [the final condition for them is worse than their original condition]

See: Nominal Adjectives

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#5)

**τὰ μιάσματα τοῦ κόσμου**

**“the defilements of the world”**

Here, the **world** refers to human society, which has been corrupted by sin. Alternate translation: [the defiling practices of sinful human society]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#6)

**ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ**

**“through the knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **knowledge** with a verbal phrase. See how you translated similar phrases in 1:2. Alternate translation: [by knowing our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#4)

**τὰ μιάσματα τοῦ κόσμου**

**“the defilements of the world”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **defilements** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the things that sinful human society does to defile itself]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#2)

**εἰ & ἀποφυγόντες τὰ μιάσματα τοῦ κόσμου, ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, τούτοις δὲ πάλιν ἐμπλακέντες ἡττῶνται, γέγονεν αὐτοῖς τὰ ἔσχατα χείρονα τῶν πρώτων**

**“if, having escaped the defilements of the world through the knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, but, having been entangled again, they have been overcome by these things, for them the last things have become worse than the first things”**

Peter is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Peter is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [they have escaped the impurities of the world through the knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, but having become entangled and overcome by them again, the last has become worse for them than the first]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

## 2 Peter 2:20 (#11)

**αὐτοῖς**

**“for them”**

## Connecting Statement:

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1 and discussed in 2:12–19. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#8)

**τῆς παραδοθείσης & ἁγίας ἐντολῆς**

**"the holy commandment that has been delivered"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the ideas behind the abstract noun **commandment** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [what God commanded and the apostles delivered]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#4)

**τὴν ὁδὸν τῆς δικαιοσύνης**

**"the way of righteousness"**

Peter speaks of life as a **way** or path. This phrase refers to the way of living life that is right and pleasing to the Lord. Peter may also be using it here to refer specifically to the Christian faith, similar to his use of "the way of truth" in 2:2 and "the straight way" in 2:15. Alternate translation: [the manner of living that pleases the Lord]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#7)

**τῆς παραδοθείσης & ἁγίας ἐντολῆς**

**"the holy commandment that has been delivered"**

Peter uses **the holy commandment** to speak of the commands of God in general. He is not referring to one specific **commandment**. These commands were **delivered** by the apostles to the believers. Alternate translation: [the holy commands that were delivered]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#2)

**αὐτοῖς**

**"for them"**

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#3)

**τὴν ὁδὸν τῆς δικαιοσύνης**

**"the way of righteousness"**

Peter is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that is characterized by **righteousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase to explain it. Alternate translation: [the righteous way]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#5)

**ἐπιγνοῦσιν**

**"having known {it"**

This clause indicates that the next clause describes an event that happened after the event of this clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [after having known it]

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#6)

**ὑποστρέψαι ἐκ τῆς & ἁγίας ἐντολῆς**

**"to turn away from the holy commandment"**

Here, **to turn away from** is a metaphor that means to stop doing something. Alternate translation: [to stop obeying the holy commandment]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#9)

**τῆς παραδοθείσης αὐτοῖς ἁγίας ἐντολῆς**

**"the holy commandment that has been delivered to them"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can express this with an active form, and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [the holy commandment that the apostles delivered to them]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 2:21 (#1)

**γὰρ**

**"For"**

Here, **For** indicates the reason why the last condition of the false teachers was worse than their first condition, as mentioned in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [This is so because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 2:22 (#1)

**συμβέβηκεν αὐτοῖς τὸ τῆς ἀληθοῦς παροιμίας**

**"This of the true proverb has happened to them"**

Here, **This** refers to the **proverb** Peter states later in this verse. It does not refer back to a statement from the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [What this true proverb says has happened to them] or [This true proverb describes what happened to them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:22 (#2)

**αὐτοῖς**

**"to them"**

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to the false teachers introduced in 2:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 2:22 (#4)

**κύων**

**"A dog"**

A **dog** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. Therefore, calling someone a **dog** was an insult. If dogs are unfamiliar to your culture and you have a different animal that is considered unclean and disgusting or whose name is used as an insult, you could use the name of this animal instead.

See: Translate Unknowns

## 2 Peter 2:22 (#5)

**ὗς**

**"a & pig"**

A **pig** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. Therefore, calling someone a **pig** was an insult. If pigs are unfamiliar to your culture and you have a different animal that is considered unclean and disgusting or whose name is used as an insult, you could use the name of this animal instead.

See: Translate Unknowns

## 2 Peter 2:22 (#3)

**κύων ἐπιστρέψας ἐπὶ τὸ ἴδιον ἐξέραμα, καί, ὗς λουσαμένη, εἰς κυλισμὸν βορβόρου**

**"A dog returns to its own vomit, and a washed pig to the rolling of mud"**

Peter uses two proverbs to illustrate what the false teachers have done. These proverbs make a figurative comparison: Just as a dog returns to eat its own vomit and a washed pig rolls in the mud again, so these false teachers, who once stopped living a sinful life, have now gone back to living sinfully. Although they knew "the way of righteousness," they went back to doing the things that defile them morally and spiritually. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning by translating these proverbs as similes. Alternate translation: [They are like dogs that eat their own vomit or like clean pigs that go back to rolling in the mud.]

See: Proverbs

## 2 Peter - Chapter 3 Introduction

### Structure and Formatting

1. Reminder that Jesus will return at the right time (3:1–13)
2. Concluding exhortation to live godly lives (3:14–17)

### Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

**Fire**
People often use fire to destroy things or to make something pure by burning off the dirt and worthless parts. Therefore, when God punishes the wicked or purifies his people, that action is often associated with fire.

**Day of the Lord**
The exact time of the coming day of the Lord will come as a surprise to people. This is what the simile "like a thief in the night" means. Because of this, Christians are to be prepared at all times for the coming of the Lord. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh; and Simile)

## 2 Peter 3:1 (#5)

**ὑμῶν & τὴν εἰλικρινῆ διάνοιαν**

**"your pure mind"**

Although the word **pure** usually refers to something being uncontaminated or not mixed with something else, Peter uses it here to indicate that his readers have minds which have not been deceived by the false teachers. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [your undeceived minds]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:1 (#1)

**ἀγαπητοί**

**“Beloved ones”**

**Beloved ones** refers here to those to whom Peter is writing, which can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [Beloved fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:1 (#2)

**ἐν αἷς**

**“in which”**

Here, **which** refers to both this letter and the previous letter that Peter had written to this group of believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could start a new sentence to say this explicitly. Alternate translation: [In both of these letters]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:1 (#3)

**διεγείρω ὑμῶν ἐν ὑπομνήσει τὴν εἰλικρινῆ διάνοιαν**

**“I arouse your pure mind in remembrance”**

Here, Peter uses **arouse**, as if the minds of his readers are asleep, to refer to causing his readers to think about these things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly. See how you translated this term in 1:13. Alternate translation: [to remind your sincere mind of these things so that you will think about them]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:1 (#4)

**ἐν ὑπομνήσει**

**“in remembrance”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **remembrance** in this phrase with a verb. See how you translated this term in 1:13. Alternate translation: [to remember]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#4)

**ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν**

**“by the holy prophets”**

Here, **prophets** refers to the Old Testament prophets whom Peter also referred to in 1:19–21. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by the holy Old Testament prophets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#3)

**τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων**

**“the words spoken previously”**

Peter is using **words** here to describe the prophecies of the Old Testament prophets that were conveyed by using words, especially those prophecies about the future return of Christ. Alternate translation: [the prophecies spoken previously]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#10)

**τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν**

**“through your apostles”**

This phrase indicates the means by which **the command of the Lord and Savior** was given to Peter’s readers. Alternate translation: [by means of your apostles]

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#7)

**τῆς & ἐντολῆς τοῦ Κυρίου καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**“the command of the Lord and Savior”**

Peter uses **command** here to speak of the commands of Jesus in general. He is not referring to one specific command. These commands were delivered by the apostles to the believers. Alternate translation: [the commands of the Lord and Savior]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#1)

**μνησθῆναι**

**“to remember”**

Here, Peter is stating a purpose for which he is writing this letter. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [that you should remember]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#11)

**τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν**

**"through your apostles"**

Here, **your apostles** could refer to: (1) the apostles who proclaimed the teachings of Christ to Peter's readers or ministered to them in some way. Alternate translation: [the apostles who serve you]; (2) all apostles, who belong to all Christians. Alternate translation: [the apostles of us all]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#6)

**τῆς & ἐντολῆς τοῦ Κυρίου καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**"the command of the Lord and Savior"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **command** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [what our Lord and Savior commanded]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#8)

**τοῦ Κυρίου**

**"of the Lord"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **Lord** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the person who rules]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#5)

**τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ Κυρίου καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**"the command of the Lord and Savior through your apostles"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the command of our Lord and Savior, which your apostles gave to you]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#2)

**τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων, ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν**

**"the words spoken previously by the holy prophets"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the words that the holy prophets spoke previously]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:2 (#9)

**Σωτῆρος**

**"Savior"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **Savior** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the person who saves]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:3 (#2)

**τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες**

**"knowing this first"**

Peter is using a statement to give an instruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this by translating it as a command. If you do so, it might be helpful to start a new sentence here. See how you translated this in 1:20. Alternate translation: [Above all, know this]

See: Statements — Other Uses

## 2 Peter 3:3 (#4)

**κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι**

**"going according to their own lusts"**

Here, Peter uses **going** to refer to habitually doing something, like someone who walks toward something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [those habitually living according to their own lusts]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:3 (#1)

**τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες**

**"knowing this first"**

Peter uses **first** here to refer to the degree of importance. It does not to refer to order in time. See how you translated this in 1:20. Alternate translation: [Most importantly, you must understand]

## 2 Peter 3:3 (#5)

**κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι**

**“going according to their own lusts”**

Here, **lusts** refers to sinful desires that are opposed to God’s will. Alternate translation: [living according to their own sinful desires]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:3 (#3)

**ἐλεύσονται & ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται**

**“mockers will come with mockery”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **mockery** with a verb. Alternate translation: [mockers will come and mock]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#3)

**ποῦ ἐστιν ἡ ἐπαγγελία τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ**

**“Where is the promise of his coming”**

Here, **Where** is used to ask what has happened to the promise. The mockers are not asking for the location of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this idiom by translating this plainly. Alternate translation: [What happened to the promise of his coming?] or [What has come about regarding the promise of his coming?]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#6)

**τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ**

**“of his coming”**

Here, **his coming** refers to the return of the Lord Jesus to earth. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the return of Jesus to earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#5)

**ἡ ἐπαγγελία τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ**

**“the promise of his coming”**

Here, the pronoun **his** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the promise of Jesus’ coming]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#9)

**πάντα οὕτως διαμένει ἀπ’ ἀρχῆς κτίσεως**

**“all things continue in the same way from the beginning of creation”**

Here, **all things** is an exaggeration the mockers use to argue that nothing in the world has ever changed, so it cannot be true that Jesus will return.

See: Hyperbole

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#7)

**ἀφ’ ἧς γὰρ οἱ πατέρες ἐκοιμήθησαν**

**“For since the fathers fell asleep”**

Here, **the fathers** is used. It could refer to: (1) the Old Testament ancestors of the Israelites, often called “the patriarchs.” Alternate translation: [For since Israel’s patriarchs fell asleep]; (2) those leaders of the first generation of Christians who had died by the time Peter wrote this letter. Alternate translation: [For since the first Christian leaders fell asleep]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#8)

**οἱ πατέρες ἐκοιμήθησαν**

**“the fathers fell asleep”**

Here, **fell asleep** is a euphemism meaning they died. You could either use a similar euphemism for death in your language or say this plainly. Alternate translation: [the fathers died]

See: Euphemism

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#4)

**ποῦ ἐστιν ἡ ἐπαγγελία τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ**

**“Where is the promise of his coming”**

Here, **promise** refers to the fulfillment of the promise that Jesus will return. Alternate translation: [Where is the fulfillment of the promise of his coming?]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#1)

**καὶ λέγοντες**

**“and saying”**

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [and they will say]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#2)

**ποῦ ἐστιν ἡ ἐπαγγελία τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ**

**“Where is the promise of his coming”**

The mockers ask this rhetorical question to emphasize that they do not believe that Jesus will return. Alternate translation: [There is no promise of his coming!] or [The promise of his coming is not true!]

See: Rhetorical Question

## 2 Peter 3:4 (#10)

**ἀπ’ ἀρχῆς κτίσεως**

**“from the beginning of creation”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **creation** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [since God created the world]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:5 (#4)

**ἐξ ὕδατος καὶ δι’ ὕδατος συνεστῶσα**

**“had been formed out of water and through water”**

This clause refers to God causing the land to come up **out of** and **through** the **water**, gathering the bodies of water together to make the land appear.

## 2 Peter 3:5 (#3)

**γῆ ἐξ ὕδατος καὶ δι’ ὕδατος συνεστῶσα τῷ τοῦ Θεοῦ λόγῳ**

**“the earth had been formed out of water and through water by the word of God”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the word of God formed the earth out of water and through water]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:5 (#5)

**τῷ τοῦ Θεοῦ λόγῳ**

**“by the word of God”**

Here, **the word of God** refers to the God’s specific commands by which the earth was created. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by the commands of God]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 3:5 (#2)

**θέλοντας ὅτι οὐρανοὶ ἦσαν ἔκπαλαι**

**“willingly, that the heavens existed long ago”**

Peter is leaving out some of the words that this clause would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the end of the verse. Alternate translation: [that the heavens existed long ago by the word of God]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 3:5 (#1)

**λανθάνει γὰρ αὐτοὺς τοῦτο, θέλοντας**

**“For this is hidden {from} them willingly”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [For they willingly hide this from themselves]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:6 (#4)

**ὕδατι κατακλυσθεὶς**

**“having been flooded by water”**

This phrase indicates the means by which the ancient world was destroyed. Alternate translation: [by having been flooded by water]

## 2 Peter 3:6 (#1)

**δι’ ὧν**

**“through which”**

Here, **which** refers both to God’s word and water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [through the word of God and water]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:6 (#2)

**ὕδατι κατακλυσθεὶς**

**“having been flooded by water”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and you can state who did the action. You may need to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [God flooded the world with water]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:6 (#3)

**ὁ τότε κόσμος**

**“the world at that time”**

Here, **at that time** refers to the time when the world existed before the flood. It does not refer to the exact time when the universe was created. Alternate translation: [the world that existed then]

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#1)

**οἱ δὲ νῦν οὐρανοὶ καὶ ἡ γῆ**

**“But the present heavens and the earth”**

Here, **But** indicates that Peter is contrasting the past destruction of the ancient world he mentioned in the previous verse with the future destruction of the present world. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this contrast explicitly. Alternate translation: [In contrast, the present heavens and the earth]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#8)

**ἡμέραν κρίσεως καὶ ἀπωλείας τῶν ἀσεβῶν ἀνθρώπων**

**“a day of judgment and destruction of the ungodly men”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **judgment** and **destruction** by stating the ideas behind them with verbal phrases. Alternate translation: [the day when God judges mankind and destroys the ungodly men]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#4)

**πυρὶ**

**“for fire”**

Here, **for** indicates the purpose for which God has been reserving the present heavens and earth. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of fire]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#3)

**τῷ αὐτῷ λόγῳ**

**“by the same word”**

Here, **word** refers to “the word of God,” which Peter said in 3:5–6 was the means by which the heavens and earth were created and a flood destroyed the world. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by the same word of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#9)

**τῶν ἀσεβῶν ἀνθρώπων**

**“of the ungodly men”**

Although the term **men** is masculine, Peter is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [of the ungodly people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#5)

**πυρὶ**

**“for fire”**

Here, Peter uses **fire** to refer to what fire does, which is burn. Alternate translation: [for burning with fire]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#7)

**εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως**

**“for a day of judgment”**

Here, **for** could refer to: (1) the purpose for which God is keeping the present heavens and earth. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of the day of judgment]; (2) the point in time up to which God is keeping the present heavens and earth. Alternate translation: [until the day of judgment]

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#6)

**τηρούμενοι εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως**

**“being kept for a day of judgment”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and say who is doing the action. It might also be helpful to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [God is keeping them for the day of judgment]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:7 (#2)

**οἱ & νῦν οὐρανοὶ καὶ ἡ γῆ, τῷ αὐτῷ λόγῳ τεθησαυρισμένοι εἰσὶν, πυρὶ**

**“the present heavens and the earth, by the same word, are having been reserved for fire”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and say who has done the action. Alternate translation: [God, by that same word, has reserved the present heavens and the earth for fire]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:8 (#2)

**ὅτι μία ἡμέρα παρὰ Κυρίῳ ὡς χίλια ἔτη**

**“that one day with the Lord {is} like 1,000 years”**

Here, **with the Lord** means “in the judgment of the Lord.” Alternate translation: [that from the Lord’s point of view, one day is like a thousand years]

## 2 Peter 3:8 (#1)

**ἓν & τοῦτο μὴ λανθανέτω ὑμᾶς**

**“let this one thing not be hidden {from} you”**

Alternate translation: [do not fail to understand this one fact] or [do not ignore this one thing]

## 2 Peter 3:8 (#3)

**μία ἡμέρα παρὰ Κυρίῳ ὡς χίλια ἔτη, καὶ χίλια ἔτη ὡς ἡμέρα μία**

**“one day with the Lord {is} like 1,000 years, and 1,000 years {are} like one day”**

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that God does not perceive of time the same way that humans do. What might seem to be a short or long time for people would not seem so for God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [one day and 1,000 years are alike for the Lord]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#2)

**ὥς τινες βραδύτητα ἡγοῦνται**

**“as some consider delay”**

Here, **some** refers to the “mockers” introduced in 3:3 and anyone else who believed that the Lord is slow to fulfill his promises, because Jesus had not yet returned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [as some, such as these mockers, consider slowness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#5)

**ἀλλὰ πάντας εἰς μετάνοιαν χωρῆσαι**

**“but all to move on to repentance”**

Peter is leaving out words that this clause would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [but he wants all to move on to repentance]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#6)

**ἀλλὰ πάντας εἰς μετάνοιαν χωρῆσαι**

**“but all to move on to repentance”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **repentance** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [but all to repent]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#3)

**ἀλλὰ μακροθυμεῖ εἰς ὑμᾶς**

**“but is patient toward you”**

Peter is leaving out a word that this clause would need in many languages in order to be complete. This word can be supplied from the beginning of the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state explicitly who is the one being **patient** and begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [But God is patient toward you]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#1)

**οὐ βραδύνει Κύριος τῆς ἐπαγγελίας**

**“The Lord does not delay {concerning} the promise”**

Here, **promise** refers to the fulfillment of the **promise** that Jesus will return. See how you translated it in 3:4. Alternate translation: [The Lord does not delay to fulfill his promise]

See: Metonymy

## 2 Peter 3:9 (#4)

**μὴ βουλόμενός τινας ἀπολέσθαι**

**“not wanting any to perish”**

This clause indicates the reason why God is delaying the return of Jesus. Alternate translation: [because he does not want any to perish]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#7)

**γῆ καὶ τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ ἔργα εὑρεθήσεται**

**"the earth and the deeds in it will be found"**

God will see all the **earth** and all the **deeds** of everyone, and he will then judge everything. If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active terms. Alternate translation: [God will find the earth and the deeds in it]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#5)

**στοιχεῖα & λυθήσεται**

**"the elements will be destroyed"**

Here, **elements** could refer to: (1) the basic elements that make up the natural universe. Alternate translation: [the components of nature will be destroyed]; (2) the heavenly bodies, such as the sun, moon, and stars. Alternate translation: [the heavenly bodies will be destroyed]

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#6)

**στοιχεῖα δὲ καυσούμενα λυθήσεται**

**"and the elements will be destroyed, being burned up"**

Here, **being burned up** refers to the means by which the elements will be destroyed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the elements will be destroyed by means of burning] or [and the elements will be destroyed by means of fire]

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#1)

**δὲ**

**"But"**

Here, **But** indicates a contrast between what the mockers believed about God and what God will really do. Although the Lord is being patient and wants people to repent, he will indeed return and bring judgment.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#2)

**ἥξει & ἡμέρα Κυρίου ὡς κλέπτης**

**"the day of the Lord will come as a thief"**

Peter speaks of the **day** when God will judge everyone as if it were a **thief** who will come unexpectedly and take people by surprise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this simile plainly. Alternate translation: [the day of the Lord will come unexpectedly]

See: Simile

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#3)

**κλέπτης, ἐν ᾗ**

**"a thief, in which"**

Here, **which** refers to "the day of the Lord". If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express this explicitly and begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [a thief. In the day of the Lord]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#9)

**γῆ καὶ τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ ἔργα εὑρεθήσεται**

**"the earth and the deeds in it will be found"**

Here, **found** indicates that the removal of the heavens and elements will leave the earth and what has been done on it exposed for God to see and judge. Alternate translation: [the earth and the deeds in it will be exposed] or [the earth and the deeds in it will be revealed]

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#8)

**γῆ καὶ τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ ἔργα εὑρεθήσεται**

**"the earth and the deeds in it will be found"**

Here, **deeds** refers to the actions of people on the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the earth and what people have done in it will be found]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:10 (#4)

**στοιχεῖα & λυθήσεται**

**"the elements will be destroyed"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in an active form and you can indicate

who will do the action. Alternate translation: [God will destroy the elements]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:11 (#4)

**ποταποὺς δεῖ ὑπάρχειν ὑμᾶς**

**"of what sort is it necessary for you to be"**

Peter is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this emphasis by translating his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. If it you translate these words as a statement, then you will need to change the question mark at the end of the next verse into a period. Alternate translation: [it is certainly necessary for you to be]

See: Rhetorical Question

## 2 Peter 3:11 (#2)

**τούτων οὕτως πάντων λυομένων**

**"All of these things being thus destroyed"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and you can state who will do the action. Alternate translation: [Since God will thus destroy all of these things]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:11 (#3)

**τούτων**

**"of these things"**

Here, **these things** refers to the heavens, the elements, and the earth mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these things that I have just described]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:11 (#5)

**ἐν ἁγίαις ἀναστροφαῖς καὶ εὐσεβείαις**

**"in holy behaviors and godliness"**

Peter is leaving out words that this clause would need in many languages in order to be complete. These words can be supplied from the context. Alternate translation: [living with holy behaviors and godly acts]

See: Ellipsis

## 2 Peter 3:11 (#1)

**τούτων οὕτως πάντων λυομένων**

**"All of these things being thus destroyed"**

This clause indicates the reason for the expected result that follows in the rest of the verse. Peter tells his readers that God's future destruction of heaven and earth should result in them living holy and godly lives. Alternate translation: [Because of all of these things being thus destroyed]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#6)

**καυσούμενα**

**"being burned up by heat"**

This phrase indicates the means by which the heavens will be destroyed. Alternate translation: [by means of being burned up by heat]

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#1)

**προσδοκῶντας καὶ σπεύδοντας**

**"waiting for and hastening"**

Here, **waiting for and hastening** are two things Peter wanted his readers to do while also living holy and godly lives, as stated in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [while expecting and hastening]

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#2)

**δι' ἣν**

**"because of which"**

Here, **which** refers to "the day of God" from the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because of that day]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#4)

**οὐρανοὶ πυρούμενοι, λυθήσονται**

**"the heavens, being set on fire, will be destroyed"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and say who will do the action. Alternate translation: [God will destroy the heavens with fire]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#3)

**πυρούμενοι**

**“being set on fire”**

This phrase indicates the means by which the heavens will be destroyed. Alternate translation: [by means of being set on fire]

## 2 Peter 3:12 (#5)

**στοιχεῖα καυσούμενα, τήκεται**

**“the elements, being burned up by heat, will be melted”**

Here, **elements** could refer to: (1) the basic elements that make up the natural universe. Alternate translation: [the components of nature will be destroyed by heat]; (2) the heavenly bodies, such as the sun, moon, and stars. Alternate translation: [the heavenly bodies will be destroyed by heat] See how you translated this in 3:10.

## 2 Peter 3:13 (#2)

**κατὰ τὸ ἐπάγγελμα αὐτοῦ**

**“according to his promise”**

Here, the pronoun **his** could refer to: (1) God. Alternate translation: [according to God’s promise]; (2) Jesus. Alternate translation: [according to Jesus’ promise]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:13 (#3)

**τὸ ἐπάγγελμα αὐτοῦ**

**“his promise”**

Here, **promise** could refer to: (1) God’s promise to create a new heavens and earth, as promised in Isaiah 65:17 and Isaiah 66:22. Alternate translation: [his promise of new heavens and a new earth]; (2) the promise of Jesus’ second coming, as in 3:4. Alternate translation: [his promise of the return of Jesus]

## 2 Peter 3:13 (#4)

**ἐν οἷς δικαιοσύνη κατοικεῖ**

**“in which righteousness dwells”**

Here, **righteousness** is spoken of as though it were a person who could dwell somewhere. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in which righteousness exists]

See: Personification

## 2 Peter 3:13 (#5)

**ἐν οἷς δικαιοσύνη κατοικεῖ**

**“in which righteousness dwells”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **righteousness** by translating the idea behind it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [in which everyone is righteous] or [in which everyone does what is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:13 (#1)

**καινοὺς & οὐρανοὺς καὶ γῆν καινὴν, κατὰ τὸ ἐπάγγελμα αὐτοῦ προσδοκῶμεν**

**“new heavens and a new earth, according to his promise, we are waiting for”**

Peter put the direct object of the main verb at the front of this sentence for emphasis. If your language uses a similar construction for emphasis, it would be appropriate to have it here in your translation. But if this construction would be confusing in your language, you could express this emphasis in another way and change the structure of the sentence. Alternate translation: [according to his promise, we are waiting for new heavens and a new earth]

See: Information Structure

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#4)

**σπουδάσατε ἄσπιλοι καὶ ἀμώμητοι αὐτῷ εὑρεθῆναι**

**“be diligent to be found spotless and blameless by him”**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in an active form. Alternate translation: [be diligent so that God will find you spotless and blameless]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#3)

**ταῦτα**

**“these things”**

Here, **these things** refers back to the events related to the coming day of the Lord, which Peter described in 3:10–13. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these things that will happen on the day of the Lord]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#6)

**αὐτῷ**

**“by him”**

Here, the pronoun **him** could refer to: (1) Jesus. Alternate translation: [by Jesus]; (2) God. Alternate translation: [by God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#1)

**διό**

**"Therefore"**

Peter uses **Therefore** to introduce a description of what his readers should do as a result of what he has just said. He is referring specifically to the discussion of the coming day of the Lord given in 3:10–13. Alternate translation: [Because of these reasons]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#2)

**ἀγαπητοί**

**"beloved ones"**

Here, **beloved ones** refers to those whom Peter is writing to, which can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. See how you translated this in 3:1. Alternate translation: [beloved fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#7)

**ἐν εἰρήνῃ**

**"in peace"**

Here, **in peace** could refer to: (1) having peace with God. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [at peace with God]; (2) feeling peace in one's heart. Alternate translation: [with peace in your heart]

## 2 Peter 3:14 (#5)

**ἄσπιλοι καὶ ἀμώμητοι**

**"spotless and blameless"**

The words **spotless** and **blameless** share similar meanings. Peter is using them together for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this connection by translating them with a single expression. Alternate translation: [completely pure]

See: Doublet

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#2)

**τὴν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν μακροθυμίαν, σωτηρίαν ἡγεῖσθε**

**"consider the patience of our Lord {to be} salvation"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **patience** and **salvation** by translating the ideas behind them with equivalent expressions. Alternate translation: [that our Lord is patient to save people]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#1)

**τὴν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν μακροθυμίαν, σωτηρίαν ἡγεῖσθε**

**"consider the patience of our Lord {to be} salvation"**

Because the Lord is patient, the day of judgment has not yet happened. This gives people an opportunity to repent and be saved, as Peter explained in 3:9. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [consider the patience of our Lord as an opportunity to repent and be saved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#6)

**κατὰ τὴν δοθεῖσαν αὐτῷ σοφίαν**

**"according to the wisdom having been given to him"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **wisdom** by translating the idea behind it with an adjective, such as "wise." Alternate translation: [according to the wise words having been given to him]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#5)

**κατὰ τὴν δοθεῖσαν αὐτῷ σοφίαν**

**"according to the wisdom having been given to him"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [according to the wisdom that God gave to him]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#3)

**σωτηρίαν**

**"to be} salvation"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **salvation** by translating the idea behind it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [to save people]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:15 (#4)

**ὁ ἀγαπητὸς ἡμῶν ἀδελφὸς Παῦλος**

**"our beloved brother Paul"**

Peter is using the term **brother** to refer to Paul as a fellow believer in Jesus. Alternate translation: [our beloved fellow Christian brother Paul]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#4)

**ἃ οἱ ἀμαθεῖς καὶ ἀστήρικτοι στρεβλοῦσιν**

**"which the ignorant and unstable distort"**

Here, **distort** is used to describe changing the meaning of a statement in order to give a false meaning like twisting something so that it changes shape. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [which the ignorant and unstable ones interpret falsely]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#1)

**ἐν πάσαις ταῖς ἐπιστολαῖς**

**"in all the letters"**

Here, the context suggests that Paul is the author of **the letters**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in all Paul's letters]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#3)

**ἃ οἱ ἀμαθεῖς καὶ ἀστήρικτοι στρεβλοῦσιν**

**"which the ignorant and unstable distort"**

Here, **which** refers to the things in Paul's letters that are difficult to understand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly and start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [The ignorant and unstable ones distort these difficult things found in Paul's letters]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#5)

**ὡς καὶ τὰς λοιπὰς Γραφὰς**

**"as also the other scriptures"**

Here, **the other scriptures** refers to both the entire Old Testament and the New Testament texts that had been written by the time Peter wrote this letter. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [as also the other authoritative scriptures]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#6)

**πρὸς τὴν ἰδίαν αὐτῶν ἀπώλειαν**

**"to their own destruction"**

Here, **to** indicates that this clause provides the result of the "ignorant and unstable ones" falsely interpreting the scriptures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [resulting in their own destruction]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#2)

**λαλῶν ἐν αὐταῖς περὶ τούτων**

**"speaking in them about these things"**

Here, **these things** could refer to: (1) the events related to the day of the Lord discussed in 3:10–13 and called "these things" in 3:14. Alternate translation: [these things that will happen on the day of the Lord]; (2) the need to live godly lives and consider that God's patience is for saving people, as discussed in 3:14–15. Alternate translation: [these things I have just said about living blamelessly and about God's patience]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

## 2 Peter 3:16 (#7)

**πρὸς τὴν ἰδίαν αὐτῶν ἀπώλειαν**

**"to their own destruction"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **destruction** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [so that they will be destroyed]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#4)

**ἵνα μὴ & ἐκπέσητε τοῦ ἰδίου στηριγμοῦ**

**"so that you might not lose your own steadfastness"**

Here, Peter speaks of **steadfastness** as if it were a possession that believers could **lose**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [so that you might not stop being steadfast]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#5)

**ἵνα μὴ & ἐκπέσητε τοῦ ἰδίου στηριγμοῦ**

**"so that you might not lose your own steadfastness"**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **steadfastness** with the adjective "steadfast." Alternate translation: [so that you might not lose your own steadfast faith]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#7)

**τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ συναπαχθέντες**

**"having been led astray by the error of the lawless ones"**

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the error of the lawless ones having led you astray]

See: Active or Passive

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#2)

**ἀγαπητοί**

**"beloved ones"**

Here, **beloved ones** refers to those whom Peter is writing to, which can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. See how you translated this in 3:1 and 3:14. Alternate translation: [beloved fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#6)

**τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ συναπαχθέντες**

**"having been led astray by the error of the lawless ones"**

This clause indicates the reason why people might lose their own steadfastness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because of being led astray by the error of the lawless ones]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#1)

**οὖν**

**"Therefore"**

### Connecting Statement:

Here, Peter uses **Therefore** to introduce a description of what his readers should do as a result of what he has said, which could be: (1) the destruction of those who falsely interpret the scriptures mentioned in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Because those who falsely interpret the Scriptures will be destroyed]; (2) the previous content of the entire letter, especially the sure destruction of the false teachers. Alternate translation: [Because of all these things I have told you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#3)

**προγινώσκοντες**

**"knowing beforehand"**

### Connecting Statement:

Here, Peter is giving the reason why his readers should heed his command in the next phrase. Alternate translation: [since you know beforehand]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#8)

**τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ συναπαχθέντες**

**"having been led astray by the error of the lawless ones"**

Here, Peter uses **led astray** to describe people being deceived into living wickedly by false teachers as if they had been led away from the straight path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly. Alternate translation: [having been deceived into living wickedly by the error of the lawless ones]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:17 (#9)

**τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ**

**“by the error of the lawless ones”**

This phrase indicates the means by which one might be led astray. Alternate translation: [by means of the error of the lawless ones]

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#1)

**αὐξάνετε & ἐν χάριτι, καὶ γνώσει τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ**

**“grow in grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ”**

Here, **grow** is used to express experiencing or having something in increasing amounts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [have more and more of the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ]

See: Metaphor

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#4)

**γνώσει**

**“knowledge”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **knowledge** by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [what you know]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#2)

**ἐν χάριτι, καὶ γνώσει**

**“in grace and knowledge”**

Here, **in** means “with reference to.” Alternate translation: [with reference to the grace and knowledge]

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#5)

**τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ Σωτῆρος**

**“of our Lord and Savior”**

Here, **our Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.” The conjunction and indicates that our also applies to **Savior**, meaning “the person who saves us.” If you include both of these phrases in your translation, then you will also need to put a comma at the end of the second phrase. Alternate translation: [of the person who rules over us and saves us,]

See: Possession

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#7)

**εἰς ἡμέραν αἰῶνος**

**“to the day of the age”**

Here, **to the day of the age** is an idiom that means “forever.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [to eternity] or [forever]

See: Idiom

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#6)

**αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα**

**“To him {be} the glory”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **glory** by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [May everyone glorify him]

See: Abstract Nouns

## 2 Peter 3:18 (#3)

**χάριτι**

**“grace”**

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract noun **grace** by translating it with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [kind acts]

See: Abstract Nouns